MACHINE TRANSCRIPT · CORAGGIO CONSULTING

Virginia Board of Education, Business Meeting, Thursday, March 17, 2022

Date	Thursday, March 17, 2022
Place	Virginia Board of Education (Virginia Department of Education), Richmond, Virginia
Length	4h 16m (video)

- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_NZ6ElwUFfU
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

> Machine transcript (speech-to-text) produced by Coraggio Consulting. Not an official county record. Names and numbers may be misspelled; check the video at the timestamp before quoting.

Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-24. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:01:08] uh welcome to another meeting of the hardest working board in the commonwealth the virginia board of education we're delighted to have everybody here uh before we get started sort of adminia due to a medical bylaws of the board i've approved electronic arms and therefore instead of having the full nine as we had last time we're down to uh six uh we will skip a compliment soon

[00:01:30] do a moment of silence uh followed by the collection of the united states of america

[00:01:59] and to the republic which stands one nation under god indivisible okay oh you know one of our members confirmed was vice president jamel wilson uh because she's not here or no longer on the board we have a vacancy in the office of uh vice president of the board are there nominations Any nominations to fill that vacancy for a term that will end June 30, 2023?

[00:02:34] I would like to nominate Dr. Mann for that position. Thank you, Dr. Anderson. Is there a second? I second the motion. Do I dare ask if you'll accept the nomination? It will be my honor. Thank you. All right. We have a motion and a second.

[00:02:53] All those in favor, signify by saying aye. Aye. Any opposed? Of course not. Thank you so much, and congratulations. We look forward to the year. - Okay, minutes, we have minutes from the January 26th and 27th meetings of the board.

[00:03:13] Is there either a motion to approve or to amend the minutes? - Motion to approve the minutes. - Thank you, Dr. Duran, is there a second? - Second. - Thank you, Dr. Anderson, any discussion? Seeing none, all in favor signify by saying aye. - Aye. - Any opposed?

[00:03:29] Thank you, Dr. Davis-Baud, I almost forgot to look up at the screen. Okay, that's fine. We're gonna move to, okay. I'd like to invite Dr. Duran to the podium to recognize our 2021 Virginia Teachers of the Year.

[00:03:45] I will say that we have sort of a cycle of things that we do with the board, different months, different recognitions. But I think for all of us, it's always a great day when the Teachers of the Year are with us. So thank you all for making the trip and thank you for the work you do for the children of the Commonwealth.

[00:04:03] Dr. Duran. - Thank you, Mr. President. It's my pleasure today to recognize eight very special people in person, since we were not able to do that last year virtually. And those are Virginia Teachers of the Year for 2021. And some of you might be wondering last month, we did recognize the Virginia Teachers of the Year, but that was for 2022.

[00:04:20] So these are those that we weren't able to do due to the pandemic. In recognizing each of these exemplary teachers today, we are confirming the excellence in education that their peers, their coworkers, and their students see from them on a daily basis. Their enthusiasm for education and their excitement for sharing their knowledge is evident not only in their classrooms, but in all aspects of their life.

[00:04:44] And their commitment and passion for one of these is a shining example of the difference a teacher can make in the lives of students every day. It is a great joy to share in this moment and to be reminded of the tremendous impact our teachers have on our Virginia students.

[00:05:00] I'd like to thank Dr. Joan Johnson, Ms. Janelle Tobort, Dr. McComer, and the entire teacher education team for their hard work to make Virginia's teacher of the year program such a success. We're honored here to have with us today these outstanding teachers, and I join all of my colleagues on the board in thanking them for their hard work and their devotion to our students in the Commonwealth.

[00:05:22] So as I introduce you, I ask that you stand and join me at the podium to accept your certificate of recognition, and then move to the side here, and then when everyone is done, we'll come up and take a group photo. So let me start with region one. Miss Sarah Frances Jurowitz is a culinary arts and baking and pastry arts instructor in Chesterfield Career and Technical Education Center.

[00:05:44] Let's give her a round of applause. She comes up. Known as a fun and engaging teacher, Chef Jurowitz encourages students to try different ingredients to solve challenges that they are given in a hands-on learning environment.

[00:06:00] Those traits, combined with lessons from her own kitchen, are posted to her YouTube channel that she shares during school closures and others. and her ability to help students evolve from burgeoning baconers to future restauranteurs and having earned her reputation as an effective and influential educator so she is affecting so many students lives in the classroom and outside and drawing from her own personal experiences she strives to ensure that no child is defined by their accommodations their learning differences their struggles their grades or their background instead she ensures that she embraces them for

[00:06:36] their character and their willingness to take risks and recognize failure as part of their educational journey graduating from the culinary institute of america in 2002 she has demonstrated her own commitment to lifelong learning seeking out numerous additional certifications including her teaching license she joined chester county public schools in 2005 as a culinary arts teacher at james river high school before moving to where she is at the career and technical center when it opened we want to thank her for being here today and again recognize her for her great i believe she's joined today by her husband and her principal they

[00:07:15] got into well be recognized thank you for being here today so let's applause to our region one 2021 teacher of the year miss sarah thank you and she'll stand on the side and we'll take a group picture shortly region two miss elisa tinge smith is a spanish teacher please come on up she's not here okay well I will still read a little bit about miss Smith miss Smith is a Spanish teacher at Jamestown High School and is representing Williamsburg James City Public Schools as the region to teacher of the year she earned her Bachelor of Arts degree in Spanish at the College of William and Mary and her master's in curriculum and instruction at the

[00:07:54] University of Virginia she continued her education earning a certificate of advanced graduate studies and her special license in teaching Spanish for grades pre-k to 12. She's taught Spanish for a variety of students from elementary to college and has served her community in many different capacities. So we recognize and thank Ms. Smith.

[00:08:14] We will honor her in her absence today. Let's give her a round of applause in her absence. Region 3, Ms. Kimberly Cannon, are you here? Not here as well. All right, Ms. Cannon teaches U.S. History at Stafford Middle School and she represents Stafford Public Schools as that Region 3 winner. She earned her bachelor's degree at the University of Marion, Washington and her master's degree from George Mason University, and she has taught for 20 years teaching at Thornburg Middle School and Chancellor Middle School in Spotsylvania before beginning her service

[00:08:46] in Stafford Middle School. So let's honor Ms. Cannon in her absence as well. Region 4, Ms. Lisa Marie Rhodes. Give her a round of applause as she comes on up. Ms. Rhodes is a 6th grade teacher at Kings Glen Elementary School, representing Fairfax County Public schools as the region four teacher here after completing her a bachelor of science in liberal studies at longwood university she has taught all curriculum subjects to sixth graders at kingsland elementary she has a firm belief in the power of learning through building and creating

[00:09:23] and she has taken the initiative to apply her experience in robotics and technology to ignite an appreciation for engineering problem solving and transforming her classroom into a makerspace where students can explore new technologies and thrive in ways they never even thought of she has also supported her fellow teachers by creating professional development supporting the integration of physical computing and computational thinking strategies into classroom instruction and has presented on the integration of robotics into the core curriculum for her colleagues principal sam ellison describes miss road as a master teacher

[00:10:00] in every way saying quote through her incredibly creative expertise her love and her devotion to her students she has become the educator whom countless students will write their college essays about end quote so let's give a big round of applause and welcome you miss rhod representing and i believe you're joined today by your husband eric is eric here please stand region five miss lisa st claire cooper you

here with us today no miss lisa st claire cooper is was a first grade teacher at Bessie Butler Elementary School, representing Stockton County Public Schools

[00:10:38] as the Region Five Teacher of the Year. And reflecting her journey into teaching, she recalled the tremendous impact her own teachers had on her life. Ms. Cooper attended Southern Virginia University and later earned her Bachelor of Arts for Mary Ball College, before moving into teaching a range of students from K through fifth grade.

[00:10:56] So let's honor Ms. St. Clair Cooper in her absence today again. Thank you. All right, Ms. Meg B. Briggs, come on up, Biggs, teaches reading for first and second grade students at High Point Elementary School.

[00:11:14] She is representing Washington County Public Schools as the Teacher of the Year. She earned her Bachelor of Science degree in Family and Child Development from Virginia Polytech Institute and State University before pursuing her certification in Reading Recovery.

[00:11:29] As a classroom teacher and a Reading Recovery specialist, she has received numerous accolades demonstrated leadership on various committees while finding time to volunteer also in her community reflecting on her own experience as a student she understands the role of teachers as champions and appreciates the need to adapt and develop new strategies to meet the needs of their students according to her principal dr sherry king she says quote as a result of her expert learning instructional delivery her motivational techniques and her compassionate care lives are

[00:12:05] forever changed let's give miss moody biggs a big round of applause thank you for being here our next honoree is miss vicky soars please come on up let's give her an applause miss soars teaches at parkview high school and represents meckonburg county public schools as their regional teacher of the year she grew up from college of william and mary with her bachelor of arts degree in psychology before earning her master's degree in special education from Hollywood University.

[00:12:38] Beginning her teaching career as a special education teacher, she has worked with a wide range of students at various levels of skill and ability, but primarily in math and social studies. She comes from a family of educators and she's a firm believer in supporting her students in all areas by addressing their social and emotional needs especially, while also making sure to empower them to be active partners in their academic journey.

[00:13:03] she has shown leadership in curriculum development and innovative approaches to secondary education and she's earned the respect of students and peers alike as demonstrated by numerous numerous awards in the words of director wesley swan from the governor's school of southside virginia quote she has grown into a outstanding educator who is always on the cusp of the most innovative ways to teach let's give her a big round of applause and i believe husband allen is here

[00:13:33] and now it is my distinct pleasure to introduce to some and welcome back um a 2021 virginia teacher of the year mr anthony swan mr swan was a fifth grade teacher during 20 when he was received this award at rocky mount elementary in franklin county but now he is serving as new role and helping students and educators alike having recently accepted a position as assistant principal at

[00:14:06] monterey elementary school in roanoke virginia congratulations on on that after earning his bachelor of science degree in elementary education from everett university he began his teaching career in 2007 in danville he also taught for a few years in north carolina and completed his master's education

and educational leadership from regent university in 2014 before coming back to virginia in 2015. upon return back to the commonwealth he taught at johnson elementary and and Rocky Mountain Elementary.

[00:14:38] And again, we're proud that he's now serving in a new role as an assistant principal. He's not only served though as a teacher in the classroom, but as an educator in all aspects of his school community. His experience providing mentoring and life skills, coaching for fifth grade boys, the Guys with Ties program, are just one of many ways he's done that.

[00:14:57] As his colleagues and peers will attest, he has a strong record of modeling integrity, honesty, and respect in all that he does. we're honored that he served with us here and helping us at the commonwealth level during his tenure on the board over the past year and we're happy to have you back here in person to recognize you in the words of one of his former students who's now a pre-med student at the university of virginia he says quote mr swan has the unique ability to spark the interest of students making them engaged in material they would otherwise dismiss he's fiercely protective of us as students

[00:15:34] and as a young kid that passion and that love for every child cannot be measured and will not be forgotten so congratulations again mr swan and i believe you're joined by your wife jasmine today um delighted she can be here and as the uh 2021 teacher of the year mr swan before we take our group photo i'll invite you up if you'd like to make a few comments on behalf of yourself and your colleagues please come up good morning mr president uh superintendent baylow board members it is a distinct honor to be able to be back here on this side i just want to say that you know i

[00:16:13] had a speech written out but i wanted to speak from the heart this morning um we know that teaching and the teaching profession um it has a negative light on it right now but i must say that there would be no other profession had it not been for teachers it was a teacher who saved my life i'm I'm not supposed to be standing right here today.

[00:16:37] You're looking at a man who grew up in the foster care system, age nine to age 21. And when I got into the system, I started to go downward. But I can remember sitting in my fourth grade classroom and getting a knock on the classroom door and it was social services.

[00:16:58] And they came to take me to emergency foster care in the middle of the school day. I was embarrassed. I was devastated. At that moment, at age nine, I had thoughts of wondering why was I alive? How come my parents didn't want me?

[00:17:13] But I remember my fourth grade teacher bending down and she whispered in my ear and she said, "Anthony, everything is going to be okay." I did not believe her. So as years progressed, this teacher found me while I was still in the system. She had a talk with me and she planted a seed and she said, "Anthony, I want you to take all of your anger, all of your frustration, all of your hatred that you have towards the world and your parents and put it into something that you want to become.

[00:17:40] What do you want to become? And I told her I wanted to become a teacher. She looked at me and she said, "For what, we don't make any money." Needless to say, she said, "If that's what you want to become, I'm going to stick with you."

[00:17:58] Still do not believe her. By the time I was in high school, she had planted that seed, so I started advocating for myself. And when I graduated from high school, my fourth grade teacher was right there and she said, "I told you everything was going to be all right."

[00:18:15] I put my own self through college because I was still in the foster care system. And my senior year, my mom died. And I remember wanting to quit. So I looked at my oldest sister and I told her that I was going to quit.

[00:18:34] She said, "You can take a break, "but you're not going to quit." Needless to say, she had contacted my fourth grade teacher. And my fourth grade teacher called me and she said, "Anthony, everything's going to be all right."

[00:18:50] I didn't have a car, this was my senior year. She said, "What do you need?" I said, I'm ready to start my student teaching, but I don't know how I'm going to get there. She reminded me that everything was going to be all right.

[00:19:08] Her name is Mrs. Joretta Wilson. She got in her car every morning. She picked me up and she took me to my student teaching placement every single day. It was a teacher who saved my life.

[00:19:25] So when I won this award, Mrs. Joretta Wilson called me and she said, Anthony, I told you everything to be all right. So when we look at teachers, When you think about the profession today, I just want you to know that it was the power of a teacher who saved my life.

[00:19:47] It was the power of a teacher who went above and beyond the classroom to make sure that my humanistic needs were met before I was considered a student. And to this day, even on yesterday, I talked to Mrs. Doretta Wilson and she reminded me that everything was going to be all right.

[00:20:07] Congratulations, regional teachers of the year. - Thank you, Mr. Swan, for those powerful words. Let's give all of our region of the year winners a round of applause. And if you could please join us up here at the front of you, we'll take a group photo with the board.

[00:20:27] And if our state superintendent can come down and vice president can come down

[00:20:32] to be with our teachers here, thank you.

[00:22:05] - That man sat with us on the board, he's being here again as a reminder that everything's gonna be all right.

[00:22:21] - Good morning. - Good morning. - This morning, it is my distinct honor to recognize Susan B. Williams, our senior assistant attorney general, as she retires from over 30 years of public service. For the past nine years, Susan has devoted her energies, capabilities, and wisdom to the improvement of public education in Virginia.

[00:22:47] Ms. Williams joined the Virginia Department of Education in 2013 as director of policy. In 2016, she transitioned to the office of attorney general, where she has served as counsel to the board. Susan has consistently advised the board and department on critical education issues in a wise, prudent, and professional manner. Her legacy of service has led to improved educational programs and the functioning of the board and the department in accordance with the laws of the commonwealth. Ms. Williams has earned respect for her public service, and I guess I'm still a

[00:23:25] lawyer, although I consider myself a recovering lawyer. I'll tell you, one of the hardest things to have is a lawyer as a client and you know susan has for me been an invaluable aid as we move the work of the board forward she has demonstrated an incredible commitment to not only the board but to the children of the commonwealth she has been accessible in a way that you know i can't tell you how important it is to be able to reach people you want to talk to and there was never a time

[00:23:59] that i could not get a hold of susan to ask questions and to get her wise advice she brought an intelligence to the analysis of what we're supposed to do and how we're supposed to do it that i consider to be unmatched in my experience as i said an awful lot about all of us and what we do and the impact of what we do and personally in addition to the board's thank you i want to thank you for really just being great i don't know how else to say it on behalf of the board i'd like to i say they've already done this emily i would have liked to present you with this resolution

[00:24:38] but somebody beat me too i would like to present you with this resolution of appreciation and thank Thank you for your service to us, to me and to everybody. Thank you. Congrats. Enjoy your time.

[00:25:05] Mr. President, Superintendent Ballow, members of the board, first of all, I want to thank you for this recognition. It means the world to me because it's coming from you all. People I respect so much for your energy and your talents and all the amazing work you do.

[00:25:21] you know it's been quite a ride for me i've spent just a little over 30 years uh in state government i've worked in the executive branch the legislative branch six state agencies and for four secretariats so um i have to tell you though that of all those places i stopped along the way um serving as your counsel has been the greatest honor and my favorite thing that i've ever done um it's both as policy director and you know and as legal counsel um you know i i grew up and some of you might not know this but i grew up the child only child actually my parents blue collar neither one of them ever attended college for a minute um my dad was a railroad mechanic my mom was cashier in

[00:25:59] a grocery store um you know my dad grew up on a tobacco farm mom was a coal miners daughter and they for probably all of those reasons um made my education their number one priority it made very clear to me that i was going to college in fact i was so convinced that you had to go to college that in seventh grade when i had my uh my meeting with the guidance counselor she asked me you know what track i wanted to go on and i said what do you mean and she said you know you get to choose what i was like i have to go to college but that's those were my parents they they knew what um a skill trade or excellent education can get you in life and it was important to them that um that i

[00:26:38] you know had those opportunities and they still they're the ones who instilled such a love of learning in me and also uh my sense of curiosity they always encouraged it regardless of how much trouble it got me into. But I, you know, I lost my dad when I was 10, but my mom and I are obviously very close. But she always said that I should be a lawyer because I would argue with a signpost. And I guess she was right. You know, I hope that you all know through the work we've done that I share your passion for excellence in public education.

[00:27:14] And it has been just the greatest honor. And I'm so thankful for the opportunity that I've to play a small part in all the amazing work you do for all the children in the commonwealth from the revising of standards of accreditation to developing the portrait of a graduate and of course to prescribing the standards of accreditation um as you all know this board has the distinction of being the only one of only two i should say um agencies that's created by the constitution and because our constitution distributes the duties and responsibilities

[00:27:48] between the board and the General Assembly and the local school boards. It has been an amazing opportunity to practice constitutional law. My favorite subject in law school, never thought I'd get the opportunity to do it. But I mentioned that because, you know, it has been an opportunity to learn so much. It has been so intellectually challenging and fascinating at the same time.

[00:28:10] And Mr. President, I want to thank you personally for asking the hard questions And then debating the answers I gave you. Maybe your time's up, Susan. And I want you to know I'm going to miss this debate.

[00:28:27] I mean, the conversation. That's what I heard. Anyway, I'm going to miss all of you so much, as well as other clients and my colleagues and friends I have from DOE days. And, you know, it's been over nine years since I missed a Board of Education meeting.

[00:28:45] So I guess I'll even miss your meetings. I thank you again for your recognition and your awards. Thank you. A round of applause.

[00:29:00] You know, people don't understand how much institutional knowledge leaves when somebody with your tenure goes. You're going to be sorely missed. Okay. We're going to move back a little bit on this agenda and introduce the Honorable Amy Guidera, Virginia Secretary of Education.

[00:29:19] We are delighted to have you here with us this morning. Before joining the Youngkin administration, Secretary Gadara was a strategic consultant helping states, foundations, companies, and non-profit organizations strengthen their efforts to improve student learning and outcomes.

[00:29:34] Prior to launching her consultancy, Amy was the founder, president, and CEO of the Data Quality Campaign, a national non-profit advocacy organization, leading the effort to ensure that students, parents, educators, and policymakers have the right information to guide their actions so that every student can excel.

[00:29:50] I will say personally, when I read your credentials, you know, when you were first named as secretary and chatted with some of the board members, we're all just so excited to have somebody that's focused on data and quality of outcome as you are and have been and demonstrated through your career, be secretary of education in Virginia.

[00:30:09] I'd like to invite you up if you want to take the opportunity to say a few words to the board. It's time, but we'd be delighted to hear from you. Good morning, Mr. President, Superintendent Baylor, members of the board.

[00:30:25] It's a delight to see you again, even on this rainy day, and happy St. Patrick's Day. It was such a delight to share lunch with you yesterday, and I look forward to continuing any of those conversations. I'm honored to be here in this position, and this is something that I believe that the last 33 years of my career has prepared me for, and not just on the data piece, but also everything I believe in, in terms of the good of the country, and the importance of equity is based on the work that you all are doing here that we need to do together, of how to ensure that every single child in the Commonwealth of Virginia is prepared for success in life, prepared to be an active member of our democracy,

[00:31:05] to be engaged people in their communities, and to be successful in our economy, which is continually changing and becoming more and more demanding. And you all play an unbelievably central role in making sure that that happens by setting the policy that's going to drive so many of these conversations to ensure that we are a best-in-class state, that we do prepare our children, not to only be competitive within the confines of the Commonwealth, but also internationally in this increasingly global world.

[00:31:35] So I look forward to doing that work with you and with so many people that we work with as the stakeholders as partners too. And partnership has been a hallmark of my career, I believe deeply, not only in the power of data, but also in the power of partnership and the power of listening and working together. And that's how I entered this conversation with you all, is that it's important to listen, and it's important to learn, and it's important together to learn, and also to problem solve.

[00:31:59] And that's what I commit to do with all of you and the folks behind us too and the stakeholders. Three is excellence in Virginia, right? As you all heard me say yesterday, the first time I came to Virginia, I came because there were excellent schools, both at the higher education level and at the K-12 level.

[00:32:15] I was a consumer of that. But excellence does not exist for every one of our children and our families in Virginia. And I would encourage us that that needs to be our guiding work together, is to ensure that every single family has quality options and that we do everything possible to fuel innovation and that we fuel opportunities for every family to have access to quality education.

[00:32:37] And that goes from everything from investing in our teachers so that every single child can have a teacher as incredible as we just heard from this morning and who we recognized. And also, how do we make sure that we fuel innovation and that we start thinking that just the way we've done it is not the way we always have to do it?

[00:32:52] And how do we encourage thinking about learning from others that are doing things better than we are? But also how do we celebrate what we are doing well and help others within the Commonwealth and across the country learn from what we're doing well too? So I encourage us to really stretch to be best in class and to make sure that we always keep that in mind as being a Commonwealth that we are going to prepare and work with every single family and every single child also to ensure that we focus on excellence.

[00:33:20] In that spirit, I just look forward to working with you, rolling up sleeves and learning together. It's so excited about the literacy conversation that was had yesterday. Data is compelling, right? We were looking at that data and we also need to be honest that things are not working all the time, that we have excellence, but we also have to be really honest about where we don't.

[00:33:39] And that will be the piece that I keep coming to this table with is, let's look at the data together, let's be honest about it, and let's also not use any excuses, but realize we have to serve every child. cannot continue to lose generations of children and be able to say that that's okay so I look forward to doing that work with you and learning with and just I'm honored to be here and really thank you thank you okay we move on to public

[00:34:17] comments speakers will be recognized in the order in which the request was received speakers are asked to limit their remarks to three minutes when your time is up please close your remarks promptly we ask that you please provide your name and affiliation at the beginning of your remarks. You may leave copies, written copies of your comments.

[00:34:35] You can email a copy to the web director of board relations, or you can hand one to her if you prefer. It is the path of this board not to respond to individual comments, but a member of staff will respond to any questions raised during your public comment.

[00:34:53] So Alan Siebert, good to have you with us. Good morning. you all. President Gecker, members of the board, Superintendent Bello, it is an honor to thank you for your service to the Commonwealth and

your service on behalf of the children and the remarkable educators who serve them. My name is Alan Siebert and I serve as Constituent Services and Government Relations Officer in Roanoke City Public Schools. I'm here this morning on behalf of our Superintendent Verlita White and the Roanoke City Public School Board. In November 2021, our board adopted a

[00:35:29] legislative position regarding chronic absenteeism, which is one of the indicators for school accreditation that position reads considering the significant and ongoing impact of covid-19 related illness exposures and quarantines and the fact that covid-19 related absences are caused by the enduring impact of the pandemic represent an attendance factor that is beyond the scope of school division attendance chronic absenteeism is not a valid indicator for the purpose of school accreditation in this school year the position further urges policy makers to implement for the the 21-22 school year a hold harmless provision for the accountability

[00:36:05] measures related to chronic absenteeism. In Ruggs City Public Schools we are very encouraged by the academic progress our students are making thanks to high quality instruction provided by extraordinary educators since the return to in-person learning. We recognize however unfinished learning and the exacerbation of the achievement gaps that were existing before that will require sustained multi-year efforts to support the whole child also please deliver to you a letter from their chair of the region state superintendent study group on behalf of the region requesting flexibility and asserting that school

[00:36:42] accreditation should focus on academic progress made despite illness and and quarantines and and exposures we in the region are collecting some data for you and we'll share it with staff our very preliminary looks and the districts didn't respond in time for me to be here today but the first ones we have back chronic absenteeism first semester 19-20 versus first semester 21-22 more than double in most places sometimes even more than more than that and the region of superintendents don't want this to be a distraction we want the conversation in the coming year to be about where children are and where they're growing and what we need to do for them not about an indicator that just really

[00:37:19] isn't telling so on behalf of sale of half of rodoch city public schools i'm here with an ask but i'm also here with an offer rodoch city public schools is fully focused on serving students in families in diverse and urban environment we are committed to being collaborative partners with you and with policymakers throughout the commonwealth because we also like you are focused on continuous improvement of the children and families we serve superintendent white has a vision to collaborate with the department as part of the soq compliance pilot she also plans to participate in a forming advisory group of interested super committed to advancing public education in the commonwealth

[00:37:58] as new efforts emerge and as the in the years ahead we would as you all seek to engage representative stakeholders in policy making we just want you to know that roanoke city public schools our superintendent our board and our entire team we're available to you and to the department as a resource thank you for your time this morning thank you matthew mcneil uh tanya francis good Good morning.

[00:38:37] Good morning. My name is Tanya Francis. I have three scholarly students who attend Richmond Appomattox Regional Governor's School. I am the president of the Richmond City Council of PTA.

[00:38:54] I am co-chair of Richmond Public Schools, School of Health and Advisory Board, Mental Health, as well as I'm a board member of NOMNY. I am here today, unfortunately, to have a big ask.

[00:39:12] um it has been brought to mention that the governor's school um with my personal experience as well as other parents do not have the iep compliance coordinator they don't have any special education teachers as well as um instructional assistants this in turn is impacting our students who do have ieps um later on you guys will get a complaint from me from one particular teacher who continues to ignore my daughter's accommodations um a lot of parents are pulling their kids out of government schools because of this reason and this is a great

[00:39:48] opportunity for our students um those parents who are disenfranchised do not need any more hardship upon it and i consider myself their voice um and i will yell and scream as loud as i can to make sure they are supported in addition um students who are minorities also are not treated so well by staff teachers when i had a young man send an email to i'm the executive director and pretty much he was reprimanded after a um female made derogatory about his sexual orientation

[00:40:25] um i've had teachers tell students that oh there's no difference in the money that women and men make they make the same amount of money for the same job when the statistics obviously prove that they don't i've had um teachers tell my daughter who asks for more diversity in the staff that minorities are not educated enough to be teachers so i have made a list of suggestions and one of my strongest suggestion is to have a advisory board with all stakeholders including um for the next three years

[00:41:02] i would like the vdoe to set up a um corrective action plan for the governor's school my tax money goes to these schools to help these children learn and i feel like if i'm spending money all kids should be treated the same um and so i am strongly encouraging that you guys look at this particular issue i i am so beyond frustrated with um the fact that there's no hierarchy there's no way for you to complain to step up between because they are so many different districts

[00:41:38] and regions that go to government school there's no complaint system and so I've done everything I could possibly do to complain to try to get things corrected and I'm a very active parent as you can see all the boards that I'm on what about thank you have a great day thank you very much Sarah Finley and I currently am here just for my second place since 2001 and I was very impressed with the

[00:42:17] status report that you all received in January regarding the work that's been done leading up to the proposed 2022 standards that you'll get in July all previous revisions have made some and have the potential to move beyond the building of skills that were introduced in the tools and help teachers assist students even more with critical thinking and further put from parents educators from all levels, and content experts. It also appears that significant efforts are underway to ensure our history is presented in a more complete

[00:42:56] and inclusive way. I really hope to encourage that you all encourage both of these results. I agree with Governor Youngman's statement in Executive Order 1. He said, and I hope in part, "We must renew its commitment to teaching our children the value of freedom of thought and diversity of ideas. We must equip our teachers to teach our students the entirety of our history, both good and bad, from the horrors of American slavery and segregation and our country's treatment of Native Americans to the triumph of America's greatest generation against the Nazi empire, the heroic efforts of Americans and civil

[00:43:35] rights movements. We must guide our students with the facts and context necessary to understand these important events, end of quote. The governor also referenced eliminating inherently divisive concepts. Frankly, I don't know what that means, and I imagine everybody has a different opinion on that, but it's hard to imagine how it wouldn't negate, in some manner, the sentiments I just read that I

really believe are a worthy goal. Fortunately, you don't have to struggle with that, um with what is inherently divisive it's no directive from the general assembly to do so

[00:44:14] and i don't see any value in going down that path i have 19 years of formal education in virginia but over the last few years i've become painfully aware of how poorly my education prepared me in certain areas particularly regarding the history of our state and country my education was largely through one lens and a clearly whitewashed version some of what i was taught was simply wrong but equally egregious were the emissions that would have presented a fuller picture of events from various perspectives one example not until a few years ago had i even heard of the tulsa massacre

[00:44:53] would this have been uncomfortable to learn about in high school absolutely but discomfort isn't to be feared ignorance is on an easier topic i learned about the space program in john glenn when i was in school but not until i saw hidden figures wasn't aware of the strong black women who helped with these efforts these are positive messages for all students from this piece of history particularly true for black children who were almost never introduced to people who looked like them doing smart and positive things this is detrimental for all students your minds would

[00:45:30] naturally draw from this that people of color or different cultures didn't do anything these are just two examples uh fortunate things are better today but i think we still have a very long way to go and i hope you'll support and insist on revisions of history and social science standards that cover our history in a more holistic and inclusive manner thank you Thank you very much.

[00:45:55] - Thank you. Nancy DeFranco.

[00:46:09] - Nancy DeFranco. I'm here today because of what is being taught in our schools. I was driving here this morning and I didn't really sit down and prepare anything. I believe that God will give me the words.

[00:46:25] It's disheartening to sit here and watch all these wonderful educators get awards and everybody talks about inclusive and equity diversity and we have so much wrong that we are teaching our kids the social emotional learning that's going on I just I don't understand why we are trying to take and raise them up at the expense of another group of children it doesn't

[00:47:01] make sense I'm in Chesterfield and what is going on in our community is it's abhorrent we had a rape by a ninth grader in our schools we have transgender bathrooms for kindergarteners you all have a responsibility and a right to make sure the children know how to read write do math have science you don't need to socially emotionally engage our children that

[00:47:38] is a parent's responsibility and we're using social emotional learning as a tool to divide our country and it's wrong teachers are not psychologists they're not psychiatrists they're not educated professionals and what we are doing to our children is wrong so i'm here today to ask you if you as a board or a personal member of the board cannot honestly look at what is going on in our schools and make a change then i'm here to ask you to resign because you need to make room for

[00:48:17] for people who really care about our children and want the best for all children based on them. Not based on what Castle says or what the grant money tells you you're supposed to do.

[00:48:33] This is not what we are supposed to do. I gave us a job, we are not doing our job. Thank you. - Jen Peterson.

[00:48:57] - Good morning, my name is Jennifer Peterson. I live in Spotsylvania, Virginia. I'm the Fredericksburg chapter lead for No Left Turn in Education. I was here in November in which I read passages from two books contained in Spotsylvania County Public Libraries, All Boys Aren't Blue and Like a Love Story. I asked this board to establish a policy book so books containing detailed passages of rape, incest, pedophilia, and sex were not in our student libraries, yet they still exist.

[00:49:21] One example of a book that is still in our Spotsylvania student libraries is by E.R. Frank titled Dime. It is about a 13-year-old who is driven by a pedophilic pimp named Daddy. He first grooms her as a father figure, then a lover, and then he turns her out. She lives with him, a 16-year-old prostitute named Brandy, and a 22-year-old prostitute named L.A. They compete for the title of Bottom Bitch to become Daddy's favorite. In the book, Dime and Brandy engage in menage-a-trois with their Johns, and Daddy takes his bitches on vacation to have a multitude of prostitutional sexual encounters so they can earn enough money to purchase an 11-year-old internet porn child named Lollipop. It is unknown at the time of her purchase she is pregnant. This is from the book. L.A. looked at Lollipop. Where's your family?

[00:50:01] Just Uncle Ray as long as I can remember. This is messed up where I muttered. She fucked already? Ellie asked Daddy, or just do what she'd do in front of the computer by herself. Lollipop was nodding yes. I was so good on the internet, Uncle Ray said my fans could start visiting me in person as soon as I turned 11. It's funny, right? Lollipop whispered to us girls.

[00:50:18] All the things men like to do, only some of them like to pat you gently. I like that, but not the rest. But Uncle Ray said it's worth the money, and I agree, because then I get everything I want pink and purple. I'm really good at it. Uncle Ray taught me that if you pretend the parts that hurt, don't hurt, And it all feels good. You like it. They give you more money. You're gonna give her date. I thought he might reach over and swat her hard But he's found she's gonna make us rich my school board comments last Monday or a week ago Monday We're recording posted a social very social media sites and within 36 hours or over 12,000 views and 200 shares

[00:50:51] This ranges from Canada to the deep south to the west coast across the US states are starting to take actions against some books Some recent examples are a vice principal in Mississippi being fired for reading a book titled I need a new butt to second graders North Carolina their lieutenant governor is getting involved the Texas governor wants roughly 800 books removed resulting in one district removing 400 of them preemptively Oklahoma proposed a bill that would permit parents to remove such books and if not removed within 30 days the employees tasked with removal Be fired and ineligible for employment for two years as well as parents can seek a minimum of ten thousand dollars per day the book remains. And in South Carolina, their governor called for an investigation in these

[00:51:29] books and possible violations of law. But here in Virginia, our headlines read, Bill to regulate sexually explicit books in school libraries killed. Virginia public schools contain images too pornographic for TV. She sucked my dick. Mom goes thermonuclear over NSFW's material in-class reading assignments. And Virginia school board decides to put sexually explicit books back into school libraries i mean how is this acceptable would you really want your daughter your son your granddaughter your grandson to read this stuff it serves nothing more than to

[00:52:03] desensitize and groom our children doris nick my name is doris connect and i have an elementary and early childhood degree as well as a t-cell certificate i live in chesterfield virginia i'm a mother of two i was previously with virginians for safe technology and a regional

[00:52:40] Facilitator for Virginia freedom keepers. I am currently with Virginians for children first and then one of the directors I'm here to speak about the disheartening fact that the video he has lost the trust of thousands of parents for choosing profit over Protection of the children. I say this because the video he has accepted the S and ARP funds and it has taken over two billion dollars for Virginia specifically in The fact sheet of the US Department of Education website it explains on page five in regards to uses of the funds and reservations The funds were given to on the condition of following CDC guidelines to the greatest extent practicable This is also tied to the Ed COVID-19 handbook created by Miguel Cardona

[00:53:19] and it's frightening and Three are made very clear in this handbook Number one funding for social-emotional learning and activism in a push for LGBTQ is listed in the Ed COVID-19 handbook number two vaccinations and masking push segregating Unvaccinated from vaccinated is clear clearly stated number three data collection For federal purposes as well as in the second handbook closing the digital divide none of these things Help protect the children. In fact, they've all cars caused harm mentally emotionally physically and spiritually I have several questions for this board Were there any video e members who opposed taking the ARP s or funds?

[00:53:56] How does allowing boys to dress the girls and use girls bathrooms make girls safer? Obscene and sexualized books have been pushed throughout the state as was mentioned prior How are these books and materials safe for young minds that means of parents watched in horror as medical freedom was Teachers and school supervisors became practicing medicine without a license and children were abused Does the video e understand that the CDC owns 57 vaccine patents and makes millions of dollars from vaccines?

[00:54:25] This is a conflict of interest if vaccines are really safe and effective and everyone should get them Then why then are vaccine manufacturers given blanket liability and no long-term studies done? Closing the division digital divide by spending these funds to purchase more wireless Chromebooks into children's hands is not keeping children safe Where are the scientific studies that wireless devices are safe for children?

[00:54:47] Has anyone looked at the 11,000 pages of evidence that was provided in regards to microwave radiation from children's health defense and the EHT FCC case from August 13th 2021 hardwiring is the answer the actions of the video we have shown that you trust the CDC, the VDH, who has done no research into mass harms, CASEL, Fauci, Iconoma, and the SDC over protecting parents, over parents protecting their children, and have allowed profits over safety, and we do not consent.

[00:55:18] The majority of guardians of children have their voices heard, and parents' rights to choose be respected. To know with full confidence that their children are safe, this is the most essential need. We want politics removed from education. We want a strong basic curriculum taught to our children effectively without inappropriate reading materials in libraries or read to our children.

[00:55:38] We want the messaging of Martin Luther King Jr., which is love and peace, not Black Lives Matter and social justice activism to be taught. They want our children to be safe and feel safe to use bathrooms in schools. Medical freedoms to be respected and never again to have children and teachers be forced to wear masks.

[00:55:55] When there is a risk, there always must be choice. Children's bodies must be respected and choice with the amount of technology used in the classrooms is essential. I have provided a wealth of

information and resources here for you. And Ms. Julian Bellow, at this point, you're the only one that I would trust as you're new in coming to the VDOE.

[00:56:12] I've given you a zip drive with the crimes that Chesterfield County has committed, and we seriously would like you to look into our superintendent. And I've also given you plenty of information. The 11,000 pages of evidence is in there as well. I hope to speak with you soon.

[00:56:28] Thank you. - Ann Tatis, Paul Fannie. I'm sorry.

[00:56:53] So SEL is being told that it's being taught in Flex Black, that it's false. It is being taught in every single curriculum. Tell me how it's appropriate to ask my sixth grader in her English class to use a Google search to find an image of a medication that can currently draw it.

[00:57:13] And then ask my 11-year-old how she came to rise. The book, The Giver, which is completely inappropriate. Before each, it was asked about eight questions how my daughter feels, like, is it okay to break laws if it's for common good? So when we talk about data mining, I campaigned hard for Yunkin, but data mining on our children is going on and there is zero accountability about where it's going and parents do not know. Surveys, they're being told, oh, here you go, here's your one

[00:57:49] survey. No, I went into my daughter, surveys are being done, they're being guided. I have a principal that listens to me and has removed during the Protection of Peer Rights Amendment that our attorney, Wendell Roberts, denied me. So I have several civil rights complaints. It states that every parent has a right to their child's curriculum and teacher training. What are they hiding? He told me to FOIA it. The same attorney that wouldn't give it who does the school board's FOIAs is a school board attorney who wouldn't give it to me. So we'll go on and we'll say more

[00:58:25] questions then there's one i like i do not like a leader i am not a leader about parents i am generally well liked in my house i am generally not well liked in my house if you can't see the destruction what you're doing to children these are children why in the world would you be asking an 11 year old to ask what prescription medications and draw a picture from google would you ask a child to do that you are destroying children with social emotional learning you use castle the money

[00:58:59] was funded by castle castle in 2020 changed it's done it is now transformative sel based on equity based on social justice so the governor's interim guidance doesn't mean nothing because it's all the same thing equity lifts one group up to bring one group down how is dumbing down education serving any children children of color being pushed through for equity it doesn't serve them no child gets an education transgender children we had a rape we have told them over and over in

[00:59:33] chesterfield clouded is not the anomaly it's happening everywhere nobody protects these children biology are not you are grooming children in gender crisis the transgender model policy was completely biased. Form a new one based on legislation. Have both sides. Have the LGBT conservatives, the log cabin Republicans who don't want this come and sit on your board to develop these policies. Same with SEL. I looked up every single one. Every single one was on the left.

[01:00:06] There are other options that you can follow legislation to have SELs until we can change the legislation that do not involve equity, CASEL, social justice, or bringing any race down to bring another one up because our children are not born hating they are taught hate and they are being taught hate in every single grade starting in kindergarten and it has to stop paul fanny one more because i missed last time paul fanny

[01:00:47] your turn sir oh thank you very much members of the board members of the audience it is both a pleasure and an honor to be before you espousing my views i do ask there are two heroes i would

[01:01:17] like to point out i hope these are here if they are let me know the first woman of note is sonia brody sonia are you here quite the pleasure man and i'm so glad to see you face to face at last thank you miss brody uh she's a great great lady uh whatever it takes to keep her here do it

[01:01:49] she's worth it number two this is emily webb where is emily webb you are another hero of mine your work is outstanding and i'm glad you're here uh it is a great pleasure knowing both of you fine fine fine ladies very fine well i prepared some notes and i i wrote one of these wonderful women an email last night i don't know if they brought the copy or not if not it's all right um i can

[01:02:28] ad lib with the best of them uh and i've only got three minutes so i'll take a sip of water and sit down and i'm done ah okay good water um there's so much to talk about i have heard some amazing comments stories from people uh your stories uh showing up made me stop and pause and some of you

[01:03:02] you're in the back for example yes ma'am yes ma'am yes ma'am uh and yes ma'am in the green you are some noteworthy individuals and i was very very happy that you came through your mind through the hearts with the rest of us we need to hear what you have to say all right because uh they're right some changes need to happen all right now i look around and i

[01:03:33] wish you would do the same with me before my three minutes are up how many 17 year olds came with you this morning anybody 17 years old in there you got me you got one all right we'll we'll talk no no but we are here on behalf of our youth so where are they uh i'm going to stir stir the fire

[01:04:08] a little bit and say well why not this let's do something a little bit controversial let's invite the youth into this room let's hear what they have to say they're human too right do they do they not also have first amendment protections of course they do the constitution doesn't apply to people only 18 and older as that is my understanding um kids have opinions you know what's it like

[01:04:42] to really be bullied in school well let's hear it straight from a horse's mouth what do the kids think about standardized tests and how they walk out after the test forgetting half of what they just said okay are we listening to these stories do we care um there are so many issues that we need to hear from our children and we're not they're not here so we don't know what they're saying

[01:05:14] okay all right and um anyway i think we should take stock and i think we should invite our youth to hang out and spend time with us the people in the ivory towers who claim to know better because we're so uneducated start up folks all right and the last issue before i exit the podium here now a comment was made and i'm not sure i agree with it or if i see it in the same light

[01:05:53] now schools offer maybe a psychologist they offer a guidance counselor but uh you know you see kids who walk out of the classroom disappointed and frustrated um and uh they start to hate school because you know i don't read so well mom i need some help i can't keep up in the classroom i need

[01:06:25] some help with me and you know i don't know who to see i don't know where to go all right so mom and dad need to fight they need to find a reading specialist the school needs to keep a close eye out on these children before we lose them before we hear the story about how oh yeah my buddy johnny

[01:07:00] well he's doing time in the nick yeah 10 to 20 for armed robbery sir i think your three minutes is up and i do appreciate your time thank you so very very much yeah yeah 11. good morning mr president

good morning madam vice president superintendent board members my name i am the

[01:07:40] the chief communications officer and Virginia chapter president of Neal Attorney and Education. I'm here about the transgender model policy. We would like the policy changed. Transgender non-binary students should be respected and accommodated on a case by case basis.

[01:07:58] If the statute cannot be amended or repealed and the video model policy cannot be amended or almost issue a statement that the office of the attorney general will not prosecute any school division that does not implement this policy. But we are asking for the following changes if possible, and I'm speaking on behalf of thousands of Virginia parents.

[01:08:20] Virginia public schools should provide, aim to provide safety, privacy, and respect to all students regardless of gender identity. Virginia public schools must respect that parents are the primary caregivers and decision makers in their own children's lives.

[01:08:35] Virginia public schools shall create policies about transgender issues that shall not harm any girl or young boy or young woman or young man, and shall not deny parents information about their own children's developmental issues or undermine a parent's role in their children's lives.

[01:08:53] Parents shall hold a primary role in helping a child make decisions about gender identity. Virginia Public Schools shall provide secondary mental health and operational support based on that decision with the knowledge, participation, and cooperation of the parents.

[01:09:09] Virginia Public Schools shall not disclose any aspect of the parent's decision to any official parent or student without the express written consent, minimal considered on case by case basis and will be handled in cooperation with the superintendent.

[01:09:27] Virginia Public Schools shall allow any student to have been officially diagnosed by a licensed medical doctor with gender dysphoria has shown evidence that such identity has been asserted for at least one year and has the written consent of their parents to use the same bathroom as the gender with which they identify.

[01:09:45] Virginia Public Schools shall install individual floor to ceiling stalls in the bathrooms of all schools within the next five years. Virginia Public Schools shall provide use of single stall private unisex bathrooms to a student immediately. Virginia Public Schools shall ensure hourly monitoring of bathrooms by SROs, school staff, and parent volunteers immediately to prevent what just happened in Chesterfield.

[01:10:08] Virginia Public Schools shall provide private changing facilities for students that do not share the same biological sex. Unisex bathroom or teachers can serve as a private changing room. Virginia Public Schools shall not allow students of different biological sex. Virginia public schools overnight accommodations with different biological sex without the express consent of all parents involved and without said student or students have been officially diagnosed with gender dysphoria by a licensed medical doctor. Virginia public schools shall allow transgender students to play sports and junior varsity and

[01:10:47] varsity teams of the gender with which to identify as long as the players height weight and body mass index falls within the range of all other players on the team Virginia public schools will allow transgender students to play sports and junior varsity and varsity teams of the gender with which identify provided they prevent proof of a gender dysphoria diagnosis from a licensed medical doctor can show

evidence to the fact that they have lived as the gender identity they assert consistently and for no less than one year and provide written parental

[01:11:19] consent Mary Keith Mary Mary Keith here okay let me go back up to me okay thank you is that covers the list of the people in advance as practice is there anybody who did not register who would please come on up we are in a time when

[01:11:59] we canceling our culture and canceling our history but there was a retired colonel from the Virginia militia in 1772 who went out to the Ohio territory to a little place called Belle Glade, later became renamed Marietta, Ohio, the county seat of Washington County. And that man was George Washington. There at the Belle Glade, he said, as our country expands and its population increases, as it will, care must be taken to have each

[01:12:39] succeeding generation know the trials and tribulations of those who preceded them history is an essential study to better government now understand this is before he was elected as general and commander-in-chief this was before he became the president of the constitutional convention this was before he was elected president the first president under this constitution the 17th president overall of the united states but this is something that's being

[01:13:19] taken away from our children is a knowledge of the history of this nation a name that's blessed to be a beacon of hope for people all around the world and if we take that from our children we are stealing from them and we're stealing from the future and we're stealing from the hopes of people all around the world so i beg you to re-emphasize history not social studies history

[01:13:52] in our schools in virginia thank you god bless you and may america bless god sir sir excuse me just one minute you don't have to but it would help our record keeping if you don't mind just giving your name like i said it's not mandatory certainly certainly i'm james renwick manship I'm a member of the Mount Vernon Board of Visitors, appointed by Governor Moore, and I have a ministry called God and Country Foundation, because George Washington said, it's my duty to God and my country.

[01:14:22] Thank you, sir. We appreciate it. I think that covers, well, let me just say, is there anybody else, I asked, is there anybody else who'd like to speak? I don't see anybody. Let me just say this. As I mentioned at the outset, the board does not respond to individual comments at these meetings.

[01:14:38] I think, you know, and even some of the speakers referenced, there's a division of responsibility in the Commonwealth for certain aspects of education. Some of it belongs with the board, supervised by the General Assembly, and some of it is with VDOE, which is Superintendent Bailo.

[01:14:58] A lot of what was said today falls into, frankly, you know, their comments about VDOE or individual school divisions. We will try to coordinate with Superintendent Bello to sort out which comments were where and who ought to respond appropriately.

[01:15:16] I mean, and I'll give an example on the transgender policy issue that is legislatively expressly given to VDOE. It is not a board. And I will tell you also, and I don't mean to suggest that to provide a disincentive for anybody to appear, Everybody on this board is always happy to hear citizens of the Commonwealth come express their views on overarching education issues.

[01:15:41] That's not the point of that comment. The point of the comment is just so that everybody has an understanding of who's got authority and we're responsible, and that's it. We are done with public

comment. I'm sorry. We're done. You know about legislation and what was passed on to you as an appointed, not elected body, and a biased legislatory.

[01:16:11] You should allow us to address what we do know about the legislation we have to do. - Okay, we will move on. - I'd like to have my hand.

[01:16:37] - All right. - By the way, last time dispatched, Judge George Washington. - Thank you. We'll move on to the consent agenda. I hope everybody's had an opportunity to review it.

[01:16:54] Is there a motion to either pull an item or to adopt items A through E on the consent agenda? I move to adopt the items on the consent agenda as listed. - Thank you, Dr. Duran. Is there a second? - Second. - Thank you, Dr. Mann. Any discussion?

[01:17:09] Seeing none, all in favor signify by saying aye. - Aye. - Any opposed? That carries. Item F, final review of proposed revisions to the guidelines for uniform performance standards and evaluation criteria for principals and superintendents.

[01:17:26] My understanding is no presentation and we are deferring to the superintendent. I may be wrong about that understanding. - I'm just here to represent, so. - Mr. President, is there a, I'm sorry, I just wanna make sure, is there a presentation or comments that you'd like to make?

[01:17:48] - Not at this time. - No. Mr. Chairman, I recommend pass it. - Okay. Let me ask first, are there any, and thank you for that. Are there any, Dr. Anderson, all those in favor signify by saying aye.

[01:18:06] - Aye. - Any opposed? Thank you, Dr. Davis-Vaught. Any opposed? I don't see any, so that carries. Item G, final review of data science standards of learning and data science standards of learning curriculum framework. We have had some internal discussion about this and I know Superintendent Bailo has some comments before we move on with this.

[01:18:29] And Ms. Mazzecane, happy to have you. I think that's you behind that mask. - There you go, okay. - Thank you, Mr. President. And I'm still getting used to, at our last meeting, I was in and out with General Assembly, so I'm still getting used to protocol and process, so I appreciate your patience, as well as the patience of the staff at VDOE, as I just become aware and educated about all of the issues in front of the board during the 2022 and 23 school years plan.

[01:19:06] Teachers involved in the pilot will receive professional development and participate in a learning cohort and also provide feedback to the Department of Education as well as stakeholder groups that we might want to engage along the way.

[01:19:21] Teams of teachers should work to develop draft curricular resources that support data science. And I also want you to know that our staff is working with Virtual Virginia to make sure that that pilot can be delivered to a number of school districts across the state not just in one area of the state I would like to see us do that for two reasons number one in Wyoming sometimes we say putting the cart before the horse and if we are doing a pilot it seems prudent to ensure that we have as much

[01:19:58] fluidity and flexibility with the standards as possible as before it goes statewide. Also, VOE will be largely responsible, if not solely responsible for delivering content to teachers to teach a new content area.

[01:20:14] At this point, I don't have enough information to understand the partnership and the collaboration and the input and the participation of higher education in this, and I would like to see us

make sure that we go through these next steps to engage their education, to get some of the framework and infrastructure in place to support a brand new content area or brand new course.

[01:20:46] The other thing is that as I visited with our staff at VDOE, and again, I apologize for my newness and being here for two months and largely consumed by Transition and General Assembly, more than the better part of that two months.

[01:21:05] This could go as a course in social sciences or it could go as a course in math. Big difference between those two courses. And I want to ensure that we do one or the other. Data science is important for all students and should be accessible in a way that is, for lack of a better term, that is in either one or the other, social science or math, math or STEM.

[01:21:41] And I am kind of going all over the place and I apologize for that, but that tells you a little bit about how much information has, and how much work has gone into these STEM. And I would like to defer for at least one month, but at the same time, the reason that I asked President Gecko to keep this item on the agenda is because I really want to hear from the board and understand better the deliberations that have taken place up to this point.

[01:22:13] And in short, in an email that I sent to President Gecker and to staff at me, and that I just outlined here, I'm concerned about the cart going before the horse. I am concerned about the space between social science and staff, and it should be one or the other.

[01:22:32] And I am concerned about the accessibility of these standards for all students. Data science is really important and it is being billed or rolled out as an advance for select divisions at this point.

[01:22:49] So, and there's no ill will or criticism for VDOE staff or board deliberations or anything like that. I'm just asking for a little bit more time be acquainted with this and to make an appropriate recommendation if i have to make a recommendation today it is simple okay um you know we have been through i guess a couple meetings with regard to the standards we had public comment on the standards i personally believe it would be

[01:23:29] appropriate for us to move this to the april agenda to give the superintendent time to fully you know flesh out i guess rationale for and where uh i think one of the issues that's going to come before the board though in april is whether to adopt or not to adopt that is to defer more or less indefinitely to allow a pilot program to go forward i think that's really what the act is um you know i'm not giving an opinion either way right now i'm just saying that i i think just Just to put this in the terms that I understand,

[01:24:07] I think what the superintendent is saying is, it is likely in April, I'm gonna ask, that we do pilot programs to better inform the final product and not adopt these as final standards. And that's, I think, something we ought to think about.

[01:24:24] As I said, I think it's a matter of courtesy. We have, in the past, relied heavily on the superintendent's recommendation. It has been a busy couple months for Superintendent Baylow, and there is apparently no harm to anything if we defer this to April.

[01:24:42] So that would be my goal here today. But that just puts off, if you will, the ultimate decision, and I don't wanna just defer it and then not have people thinking about what the real underlying issue is here, because there's a significant underlying issue to the request.

[01:25:01] - Mr. President, I appreciate that. And again, there are so many spaces to fill in my knowledge right now. And board discussion is one of those. By looking back at minutes and looking back at discussions by the board, which I intend to do and commit to doing.

[01:25:24] Also by having continued conversations with VDOE staff about some of those spaces that I still have that are outstanding. perhaps we can reach some reconciliation to go forward. But there are those outstanding issues in my mind, particularly related to the accessibility, the training, and the order of operations with respect to these standards.

[01:25:53] And it is not to say that I don't see value or merit in a data science course. And at the end of the day, it may be, Do we go forward with a pilot program without finalized or approved standards of learning, or do we need to have approved standards of learning before we go forward with the pilot program?

[01:26:18] And perhaps that's something that, just in my two months here, I don't have full knowledge of what the process is, but it seems-- - My understanding that a number of divisions, this correct are prepared to offer the course once we adopt or if we adopt miss holton so i appreciate the superintendent's input and have absolutely no problem with the month delay

[01:26:52] i would just suggest that we use the month profitably and i would encourage the department to seek the input of the divisions of the districts and particularly curriculum development folks i would think would be key but i'm sure there are other stakeholders groups um superintendents vsba etc that may have an opinion on whether there's some downside to waiting um the year and also certainly invite here that the stakeholder groups want to speak directly to us on the board we'd be happy to hear their public comment on the so i think it's great that you all

[01:27:27] are identifying the the options of either we go forward in april or we delay perhaps as much as a year or more and invite the districts who are really closer to the ground on this to tell us if there's some downside to that we should be aware of. It would also be helpful to me, Superintendent, if staff explained the technical issues or requirements of doing a pilot that is outside of our experience.

[01:27:58] What might have to change, if anything, to accommodate a pilot so that people get credit appropriately etc i don't pretend to know all the ins and outs of that and it would be helpful to have some understanding of what that would look like administratively and from the division level yeah and mr president i i have an idea about that um and i want to be really clear videos videoe staff has been incredibly gracious with their time um and the information that they have

[01:28:31] shared with me it is it is simply that there has not been enough time for me to make an appropriate recommendation at this time and and i know that there are some technical issues with uh going forward with a a pilot and not having finalized standards but i'm not sure that they're insurmountable technical issues that would keep us. I know. I just want to understand what they are so that I can wait. I agree. And Mr. President, I so appreciate your patience and grace in allowing me that extra

[01:29:09] time. I appreciate it. Any other questions? Dr. Mann. Yes. I too appreciate this conversation. And I guess I am wondering when we come back in April, then really thinking about concretely what we're going to be looking at. If you're saying, superintendent, that you have some ideas about how this might roll out and what the technical issues might be with it. Are we imagining that there's going to be a plan, a

proposal that speaks to a pilot? I just want to orient my mind around sort of what we're going to be looking at in an effort to get to a sort of go, no go, or decision

[01:29:46] around it. Mr. President and Madam Vice President, thank you for that question. And my hope is that staff and I will continue to meet over the course of the next month. And staff will be able to fill in the gaps, the knowledge gaps that I have outstanding at this time, and also make a presentation with adjustments or changes necessary.

[01:30:15] And then we can have that conversation as a board. And I don't necessarily think those will be major changes um philosophically or in terms of direction or or timing of courses being able to be offered in our school divisions but i do imagine that we will be able to come back to you in a month with um with addition with my additional information and staff additional information from staff about how we are making sure that our teachers who are teaching this

[01:30:52] understand that it is either a social science credit or a math credit not both or either or that it is the the professional development is um in their path or a clear process for ensuring that there is flexibility with these standards of learning to do two things other one is to make changes to the standards of learning uh as we learn lessons through the pilot and number two is is that we have clearly a process to identify and standards of learning

[01:31:29] need to be incorporated into other standards of learning throughout all of the sets of standards of learning because this is important and then and then lastly i would say that i i think that it is also important for us to make sure that we are able to offer the pilot program statewide i know that there has been some general interest from a smaller region of virginia school divisions and i would like to see us have a very specific plan on how we will engage our rural districts

[01:32:06] and some of the districts that have not identified themselves as being interested in this pilot project um having a firm commitment from from some of those school divisions will be really important in my mind to bring to you as the board so that you know who's involved in the school division who's involved in the in the pilot project how that input will be coming to you um how those teachers will be trained to deliver uh the the content areas and what those courses will look like in schools okay i think that covers all the questions uh dr davis vaught do you have any

[01:32:45] questions nope don't see to give us and give herself some time to acclimate and i appreciate everyone's understanding defer this item to the april agenda all right item h can overview of uh abtel's recommendation for passing score for the middle or for praxis middle school math 5164 test for the middle education 6-8 mathematics enforcement this president may serve as the

[01:33:21] assistant superintendent for teacher ed and literature i add the final reviews for items h and i given the similarity in the methodology and the procedures and so i also want to recognize today we have with us as well our director of client relations from ets from new jersey malik mckinley he's also here to support our items today again just a quick summary this is the final

[01:33:52] review regarding the two math praxis assessments a brief background currently the board requires the following assessments for initial licensure the virgin communications and literacy assessment or the vcla praxis subject assessments and reading for virginia educators or the rve for a specific endorsements the board prescribes the praxis subject assessments as a professional teacher's assessment requirement for initial licensure in our state the current prescribed

[01:34:29] assessments for both the mathematics endorsement and the middle school endorsements have been and the regenerated praxis tests will be offered by the educational testing services or ets and a cut score needs to be established for the revised test you'll note in item h focus on the praxis middle school mathematics assessment five one six four six eight mathematics endorsement the test will be required for individuals seeking visual as well as those that wish to test or add

[01:35:03] that endorsement by testing to their valid license for renewal item h the proposed recommendation relates to the mathematics assessment 5165 test for mathematics endorsement the tests will be required for individuals seek initial licensure for mathematics as well as an opportunity to add by testing to add that mathematics endorsement to a valid license again we have supplied the the customary attachments of the multi-state standard report for both middle school and

[01:35:43] mathematics as well as the Virginia reports the technical report contains three sections the first section describes content the format of the test the second section section describes the standard setting processes and methods and finally the praxis study companion as you may remember the advisory board received this presentation from the ets representatives on october 27 2021 and as we have shared previously the abtel board members reviewed

[01:36:19] the standard setting report and recommended that the board approved the passing score at minus one ces em or 150 below standard setting panels recommendation for item h for item i the advisory board members reviewed the standard setting report and recommended that the board of education approved the passing score of 152 and minus one csem below the standards recommended by the panel however since the january meeting an updated recommendation from the state superintendent

[01:36:56] so for today the state superintendent has recommended that the board establish a cut score of 157 for the practice middle school mathematics 5164 test and this does align with the recommendation from ets individuals may take either the current prescribed assessment for the middle school mathematics practice middle school mathematics 5169 or the new practices middle school mathematics 514 tests through august 2021 in september 22 only the new praxis middle school mathematics

[01:37:33] 5164 tests will be offered in virginia beginning september 2022 the praxis middle school mathematics 5169 test will be accepted only for those individuals who took and passed the test during the period it was prescribed by the board related to item 8 excuse me i and the state superintendents of public of 159 again aligning with the ets recommendation in the self multi-state self-study individuals may take either the current prescribed assessment for mathematics practices

[01:38:10] the content knowledge 5161 tests or the new math assessment at 5165 tests through august 22 and again in september 22 only the new practices 5165 tests will be offered in virginia beginning September 22, the Praxis Math Content Knowledge 5161 test will be accepted only for those individuals who took and passed the test during the period it was prescribed by the board.

[01:38:36] I'll welcome any questions at this time. Dr. Duran. Thank you for the review and since January revisiting and say superintendent the score a couple of us were concerned at the recommendation and the fact that it was much lower than surrounding states so I want to just make I want to make sure I understood you correctly, either this student or this student or this student or this student or this student.

[01:38:59] The 457-69 help us to understand how does that compare now to other students and use recommendation of ETS, but does it now put us now in a more comparable place to be with the folks from

ETS Praxis?

[01:39:16] And asked them as an overachiever, why wouldn't we want to be above the cut score that's recommended by ETS? We want our math teachers to be the very best. they i think i knew the answer to that before i asked but i wanted to hear from the professionals explained it well the cost score established by ets is really that line in the sand do the teachers have the knowledge that they need to go into a classroom on day and have have content knowledge maybe not the pedagogy maybe not the experience maybe not the

[01:39:53] classroom management but do they have the content knowledge to adequately teach the course and the answer is yes so going above that doesn't necessarily in the way that we have a teacher but it always suggests that we have someone knows the content area adequately and i i think that's really important the moment that we go above that cut score we can't guarantee that we still can't guarantee that they're not great in every other area but they do not demonstrate the content

[01:40:29] knowledge needed to enter school or enter a classroom day one and teach the content area thank you for that further explanation i think it's really important that we do have teachers who are prepared and not being below so i'm glad that i appreciate you taking the time to look into that i know in january you were seeing it for the first time yourself so i'm really supportive now of this change and i'll be certainly supporting these new recommendations so thank you very much and and dr duran um if if i might just add um we this was an important conversation i didn't have time for all of the conversations and all of the depth of conversation but this was

[01:41:06] important uh to recognize the uh the teacher shortage the uh desire to ensure that we have diversity in the classroom and the the impetus was really there for aptel recommendation i think it would behoove the board to continue having conversations about ensuring that we have a diverse workforce and ensuring that we um that that we do whatever we can as a board within our power

[01:41:39] to address the teacher shortage this is not the entry point to do that and um so i appreciate those continued conversations among the board in the in the weeks months and years to come because it is a real issue teacher shortage and ensuring uh that that we have a diverse workforce are things that are items are topics that this board needs to continue talking about and we need to to continue to probe where our entry points are as a board but this isn't one of them one final comment thank you mr president to that is i think it's really really important that we continue

[01:42:16] thinking about diversity of our candidates but also excellence and those are often in my mind misunderstood when we talk about equity we talk about diversity we talk about wanting to have inclusivity we cannot mix the fact that we're saying then we don't want excellence we don't want high standards we don't want quality and when it's misused that way we have to make sure that we continue to correct that because diversity and equity excellence do exist and should exist and it has to be part of our conversation we have to look at the data for the applicants who are diverse or not diverse during our students but we must do it with excellence in mind as well

[01:42:54] so thank you for that mr president i have a question or comment really comment i appreciate all the extra data that you provided i very much took my time and really went through this and i certainly agree with the importance of setting a standard and having high standards for certain i think it was very disconcerting to see actually the pass rate over you know many years looking at one of the tests in particular and what it prompted me to think about especially

[01:43:33] since we're talking about the importance of innovation and the spirit of innovation is really considering not at this point i know we have a very different decision ahead of us but at your invitation to really think about where can we go with actually trying to evolve how we understand who's highly qualified and prepared to do this work and i feel like there is an opportunity to perhaps look at academic performance concentration of math courses how people do with

[01:44:08] those courses coupled with student growth to really see if in fact there are some people that are being locked out. I mean, a test rate that's like 50% of the students not passing. And my mind tells me something's wrong with the tool. People are not getting access in higher education to the kind of content that they need, but we're penalizing the adults in ways that are, I think, limiting students to teachers who, in fact, might be prepared with the baseline content

[01:44:45] to teach and i feel like if we're going to talk about innovation and ways that we can stop doing the things that we've always done as the only answer to getting at sort of our workforce shortage we need to be open to that so maybe there's a provisional opportunity for people when you look at transcripts concentration of course content all of those things and marry them up with how well are students doing because we can't stay on this path where you're seeing tests actually result

[01:45:18] in you know 55 of the students passing that's not the trend rate that we see with some of the other data that you very thoughtfully provided you know 70 or so was the you know three-year average for the other tests so i i think if we're going to be about innovation let's be about innovation in some of these other areas as well, because something is wrong somewhere that we're not pinpointing that we've got to get on top of. So I really, really appreciate your digging into this

[01:45:55] information and providing a window into really understanding this from a different point of view. I certainly support high standards, and this is not about not trying to have a high standard, but it's trying it is about for me making sure we're looking at information in ways that challenge us to not just do what we've always done everybody else i agree i just want to add a little bit to what you said dr man i certainly agree with that i think that as a board and as educators as people

[01:46:30] leading and educational institutions we all have to be mindful though or thinking about assessment it's one piece of that and to your point i think the innovation needs to come in and we need to look closer at how we're preparing our future educators how we're preparing our teachers to be able to take assessments that are a part of this process they are a part of this process and when we see the scores as low as they are in terms of the pass rate it's not always just about the assessment there may be i believe the opportunity and we have looked at this board many times at our assessments to see where there might be some innovation but i also think we should be looking at the full picture because i think and someone who got with many teachers who've gone

[01:47:06] through preparation programs they've shared with me holes in their preparation and their inability and so i think it behooves us to have the conversation that you're asking but make it more comprehensive to not be limited to just the assessment that's what's before us today so i understand that's why we're focusing on that today but i would hope that our videoe department can continue i know you are doing this but continue to dig deep at that data you're describing to say this is unacceptable that we have this amount of our teacher candidates that are not passing what is told to us by ets is the bare minimum for what shows success and so how do we continue to work to develop and change the preparation and assist those who are taking these assessments

[01:47:46] because i believe it's a full part of the process not just looking at one piece that's not what you were saying i just wanted to add to that to say how important because of course today what's on the agenda is just the assessment but i do think that you're right innovation innovation innovation around the whole system of teacher preparation and assessment not just the assessment but the whole piece is what i'm saying and yes i certainly agree with you and i believe abtel is also in support of that and we are trying to explore some options and so i i welcome the conversation and i appreciate the support in exploring some other options for that i know um board member holton

[01:48:22] will also be joining with me now with aptel to help us take a look at some of these issues just be clear, I think, from my perspective. The issue before us today, the practice issue, is really just one measure of mastery of a content area, which is one of the essential components of being able to teach that content area. And I think, Dr. Mann, what you are suggesting, which I don't disagree with, is that there may be other methods or other means to assess

[01:49:00] whether an individual has mastery of that content area uh you know with the suggestion that perhaps either the testing or the prep within you know is not adequate to see if everybody has got you know or if each individual has that mastery necessary to be able to communicate in the classroom because we all know that you know without content mastery the effectiveness of the teacher diminishes therefore the outcomes diminish and our goal is to improve student outcomes the one linkage that that I don't like, and this is not directed at you, Dr. Mann, at all, is the linkage to, we have a teacher shortage.

[01:49:39] Every time I hear that in conversations, dealing with, you know, standards for mastery or for who can be a teacher, you know, I don't believe that the remedy to teacher shortage is to in any way lower the standards either by, and I know that's not what you said, but again, that linkage always, you know, To me, they're independent questions, right?

[01:50:04] Can we find alternative assessments that identify people who have got sufficient content mastery to teach? I think the answer to that is yes. Should we do that because we have a teacher shortage? I think the answer to that is no. I think we're gonna do that because there are people who want to teach, who can teach, you know, with the appropriate qualifications that we are not identifying with the way we're doing it now.

[01:50:24] The teacher shortage issue is one that, you know, this board has talked about a lot. And, you know, I hate to say it, but the answers there are more simple than people want to believe. Number one is you cannot expect to have a lot of people move to a profession where the pay is, pick a number of 30% less than the pay for comparably educated individuals.

[01:50:46] I mean, it just defies logic to believe that we're gonna be successful with that as a model. Number two, it defies logic to believe that to move people into a profession where at times, and I know not in Arlington, but in some jurisdictions, the support of younger teachers isn't sufficient them in the profession. One of the things the board addressed through the prescribed standards of quality is to provide that framework of support around younger teachers, because if you look, and this is not post-pandemic, but certainly pre-pandemic, the numbers were such that

[01:51:19] if we could alleviate the flow of teachers out of the profession in their younger years, years four to seven, let's say, we would have had sufficient teachers to fill every spot in the commonwealth. Post-pandemic, I haven't seen those numbers, so I'm not speaking to that.

[01:51:37] But it's clear we have a problem with how do we retain, right? Attraction and retention. Attraction is, you know, pay in part in working conditions. Retention is support working conditions. And we have addressed that through the prescribed SOQs, which have not yet been adopted or really, frankly, talked about seriously in the General Assembly. We continue to hope that that framework that we, you know, suggest that is with mentorship, better building leadership, et cetera, will be taken up seriously, you know, at some point, you know, certainly I hope in my tenure on the board.

[01:52:13] In any event, the items before us, H and I, I think are pretty straightforward and relatively simple, and I think as a matter of policy, the board agrees that the way to go forward is, you know, with the, with a passing score in both 5164 and 5165 tests as recommended by ETS.

[01:52:36] And, you know, we put this off in order to give the superintendent time to look at it. I'm grateful that you took the time to look at it. We have the recommendation to adopt those. So I will ask, is there a motion to adopt item H? - So moved. - With a pass cut score of 157.

[01:52:54] Thank you, Dr. Duran. Is there a second? - Second. - Thank you, Dr. Davis-Vault. All in favor signify by saying aye. - Aye. - Any opposed? Okay, item I, is there a motion to adopt the cuts 159?

[01:53:09] Dr. Johnson, make sure I get the right numbers, which is the ETS. That's right, is it 157 and 159? I just want to be 100% sure. That's what I wrote down, but great. Okay, is there a motion?

[01:53:27] 159 for item I. - So moved. - Thank you, Ms. Holton, is there a second? - Second. - We'll have two seconds on that one. All in favor, signify by saying aye. - Aye. that one carries also uh i think it's 11 we've been here two hours we're going to take a 10

[01:53:47] minute break if that's okay with everybody and we'll be back at 11 10. we're going to call the

[02:06:35] meeting back to order and where's i guess dr johnson items jkl and m okay let me get all

[02:06:50] greetings again welcome back gecker vice president man um i'll be before you again i would request

[02:07:26] that i be able to present the items k and j simultaneously i will do my best to make clear for you because again the methodology is very similar in the process and so excuse me i highlight again that background information currently the board requires the following assessments for initial licensure the vcla or the virginia communication and literacy assessment praxis subject assessments and reading for virginia educators or the rve for specific endorsements specifically related to k

[02:08:03] item k the board prescribes subject assessments as a professional teacher's assessment requirement for initial licensure in virginia in addition the reading for virginia educators or what we have called the elementary and special ed rve is required for individuals seeking initial license in the following areas or endorsements early primary education pre-k through three elementary education pre-k through six special education general curriculum special education hearing

[02:08:34] impairment and special ed visual impairment the new praxis teaching reading for elementary 5205 test will replace the reading for virginia educators or the rve elementary and special education by 306 tests the practice reading elementary test focuses on knowledge and skills a beginning teacher must have to support reading and writing development in kindergarten through sixth grade built to assess the science of reading the test is structured around five

[02:09:11] essential components of effective reading instruction as identified by the national reading panel phenomic awareness phonics vocabulary frequency and comprehension the test also assess the relationship between reading skills and writing sets the relationship between those two specifically for item j i want to highlight the current board of education prescribed assessment for reading specialist is the reading for read virginia educators of rve for reading specialists

[02:09:44] test 5304 the new praxis reading specialist 5302 test will replace the reading for virginia educators rve the reading specialist 5 excuse me 5304 tests the praxis reading specialist 5304 is intended primarily for persons who have advanced academic preparation and or who have considered are being considered for supervisory or instructional positions around or related to to teaching and reading instruction in grades K through 12.

[02:10:20] The test is appropriate for candidates for advanced preparation, for example, math, excuse me, a master's degree or math course, master's level coursework, who have specialized possibilities related to teaching of reading at any level, again, of K-12.

[02:10:37] It is also appropriate for individuals who wish to consider for supervisory positions, such as reading clinicians, consultants, supervisors, specialist coaches coordinators for more than teaching of developmental reading in a regular class setting.

[02:10:53] Again, related to item J, the content of the test is based largely on the 2017 standards for the preparation professionals created by the International Literacy Association, and reorganized around the domains to highlight five components of literacy as defined by the national reading panel.

[02:11:14] Additionally, the test has been updated to reflect current research and terminology related to the science of reading. I will highlight here that the two reading assessments before you are those that will address the stipulation containing the new Virginia Literacy Act for the rigorous test for assessment of science-based reading research and evidence-based literacy instruction for initial or alternate routes.

[02:11:40] As is customary, between February 19 and January 20, multi-state standard setting studies were developed and conducted by ETS around both of the assessments before you today. Virginia did not participate in the multi-state standard due to staff hire and transition.

[02:12:01] Instead, ETS facilitated a panel discussion with six Virginia educators that married the state multi-state standard process methodology and procedures. As detailed summaries that you have before you include the multi-state standard setting technical report, the for teaching reading elementary 520 access reading specialist 5302 are included as well as the Virginia report from the panels.

[02:12:31] But as you are aware, the technical report contains the three sections describing the content, the standard setting process, the methodology, and the third section, the results of the standard setting study.

[02:12:47] You have before you the chart that represents the estimated conditional standard of error around the recommendation from those studies. And on November the 21st of 21, information regarding the multi-state sanding setting presentation, excuse me, was presented to Abtel with the advisory board by David Dickerman, the reading specialist, and Malik McKinley from both from ETS.

[02:13:21] The ETS presentation also is included for your reference. As relates to item J, the advisory board reviewed the multi-state center setting report and agreed with the passing score and now

recommends that the board approve the passing score of 73 out of a possible 107 raw score for the practice reading specialist 5302 test.

[02:13:45] The scale score associated with the raw score of 73 is 165 on a 100 to 200 scale. The recommendation of ABTEL is based on the supporting evidence from the multi-state standard-setting process and evidence from the Virginia panel study outcome.

[02:14:08] As relates to item K, the advisory members reviewed the standard-setting report and, again, agreed with the passing score from the multi-state standard-setting study. and now recommend that board approve the passing score of 67 out of possible 107 raw score points for the practice teaching reading or the elementary 5205 tests the scale score associated with the raw score is 67 is one out of 159 on the 100 to 200 scale and recommendation from the state

[02:14:45] superintendent for item k the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board receive the first for first review the recommendation of the advisory board of teacher education and licensure to establish a cut score 159 for the praxis teaching reading elementary 5205 tests and for item j the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board receive first review the recommendation of the advisory board to establish a cut score of 165 for the praxis reading specialist test i'm available for questions that's great thank you are there

[02:15:23] any questions items j or k uh miss holton recognizing this is on first review right i just want to make sure that we're aligned with everything we heard yesterday and i do see that the Praxis revision is fully incorporating the national reading panels emphasis on the five content areas that we heard about yesterday But I if I also if I understood correctly Mississippi is using a

[02:15:56] Some a different assessment than is that in addition to the praxis or is that instead of the praxis? And is that something we're thinking about in the long run? And does this effort, you know proving a cut score for practice is this an interim measure moving us towards For both reading specialist and elementary reading Something more with the professional development we're going to be doing around literacy or are we are we able to speak to that yet?

[02:16:26] Is it just premature? President through you and Miss Holton, did you read my notes? From yesterday because that's exactly what I wrote down I heard the same thing from Mississippi, that they have perhaps an additional assessment for teachers that is specific to the science of reading for K-2 teachers.

[02:16:48] This will encompass and is aligned with the science of reading. We've checked that, but it is a little more broad. And so that is something that we should certainly continue to discuss, and perhaps staff has some additional insight on to that. um but i i would like to continue having that discussion about what what other measures do our earliest teach or our earliest uh learners need to see in their hand let me rephrase that our k-2 teachers what else do they need to know to be effective in the classroom and it may be that the answer on this is that we need to we have we're using the praxis we

[02:17:27] got to have a cut score for the practice so let's get that right but as well and the test has changed and is it partly to accommodate this science of reading evidence? - That's correct. - Okay, good, good. So this is a step in the right direction and whether it's the ultimate step or whether there's something additional or alternative that we should do eventually as part of the literacy plan, that's a future question, but this is a step in the right direction.

[02:17:54] - Yes, okay, thank you. - Anybody else? If not, we are happy to accept items J and K on first review. L and M? Again, for first review, the advisory board on teacher education and licensure recommends new education endorsement programs.

[02:18:14] As you're aware, the regulations governing the review and approval of education programs in Virginia require that the Virginia Board of Education approve requests for Virginia institutions of higher ed to add new endorsements programs. Requests for those new programs must be submitted annually to our department by March 31st.

[02:18:35] Virginia Department of Education staff especially we want to give acknowledgement of our specialists in the learning and innovation department as well as our staff in teaching ed and licensure have verified program endorsement competencies through the review of course descriptions syllabi as well as any other supporting documents including clinical or supervised class instructions in alignment with the regulatory criteria a review of the request of new endorsement program applications submitted by the institution's evidence written documentation of school

[02:19:11] division demand data institutional and school division support as well as partnership and collaboration based on pre-k through 12 school needs on january 31st 2022 abtel recommend that the board grant approval of the new endorsement programs listed in the item i'll just highlight them from blue excuse me bridgewater college an add-on in journalism at the undergrad level liberty university engineering at the graduate level randolph college computer science visual arts and history and social science at the graduate level university of

[02:19:50] richmond foreign language french german latin spanish all at the graduate level virginia state university visual arts pre-k through 12 at the undergrad and virginia tech career and technical education and agricultural education english mathematics history and social science all at the undergrad level and at this time in conclusion i will provide the superintendent of public instructions recommendation that the board waive first review and approve aptel's recommendation to approve new education endorsement programs i'm available for any questions any questions

[02:20:34] just ask what's the reason to waive first review here um precedent generally has been established that there will be no additional information, I guess, that could be provided. - Yes, is there a need to do it today for a reason?

[02:20:54] The policy of the board typically to have these items presented publicly because, potentially, sometimes folks from the public comment in the intervening month. - Sure, as we have highlighted, because of some of the change in staff and the time that it takes to review these, We are quite far behind, to be honest with you, in the review of these new endorsements.

[02:21:17] Many of them were submitted, well, all of them were submitted in 2021. And the universities, as well as their administrators, are quite concerned that it has taken us this long to review the programs. And there has been precedent that generally the approval process is taken on first review.

[02:21:35] But it's the will of the board. - I will note that they were, it was publicly noticed for today. I don't remember, did your agenda item indicate that you were gonna ask to waive first review? - Yes. - So the public was on notice of that potential today.

[02:21:51] - Mr. President, during my briefing on this particular agenda item, I asked multiple questions about the vetting and review process leading up to this and also asked the question that you asked, why

would we waive first review for the same reasons and made my recommendation based on assurances that this has been thoroughly vetted by other groups.

[02:22:18] And there has been an opportunity for the public to weigh in on these issues in other venues. However, we are happy to go a different route.

[02:22:34] - I'm just asking, I wanna understand How much, when we say other vetting, what stakeholder groups were involved with this, if any? - Well, the application from the EPPs require them to submit partnership documentation with various school divisions and other agencies.

[02:22:57] Was there some support by potentially a president or a dean of the institution? Those are collected in support of the needs and shortages that are driving the divisions. And then that information is reviewed by our department in terms of alignment with regulations.

[02:23:16] And then it's also vetted with the content specialists with the various endorsements that are part of our innovation and learning team, often reviewing, aligning it with the regulation competencies required as well as any other updates that may be required from the VDOE in terms of guidance and content.

[02:23:36] And then the back and forth is also there between the institution to clarify any questions or concerns until the specialists are satisfied that the content endorsement outline in the regulations are met. And then as you know, there are biannual reviews of the programs, as well as a seven year review of the programs for accreditation.

[02:24:00] - All right, so will of the board issue. So what people wanna do, they're not gonna stand in the way of doing this today, if that's the will of the board. - I would make a motion to waive first review. We haven't done it before, and I think the comprehensive review that was described and the deeper dive to make sure that we had all this information, and the fact I do know from universities wanting to get this quickly so they can prepare for these programs.

[02:24:24] So it was listed, as Mr. Holton said, to the public as waiving first review. So it's not something we're deciding right now without public comment, so I would make a motion. - Everything we do is listed for the public, And yet often we say, because of the content area, we want to give a following presentation, you know, the board presentation, the public time to respond.

[02:24:46] I mean, I understand that argument. And like I said, this is not one that I think I'll live to regret, at least I hope I don't, but I appreciate the motion. Is there a second? - Second. - All right, any other discussion? All in favor signify by saying aye.

[02:25:02] - Aye. - Any opposed? Thank you. Any opposed? All right, that carries. - Sure. - Dr. Johnson. - Sure, I bring before you first review of amendments to the licensure regulations for school personnel to comport with American Sign Language national certification that's on a fast track action.

[02:25:22] Currently, the licensure regulations for school personnel provide requirements for individuals seeking an endorsement for foreign language, pre-K through 12, and in American Sign Language, or ASL. The prescribed certifications for the endorsement that are issued by national organizations are not currently in the regulations for our state, and therefore, individuals who apply for the American Sign Language certificate do not have the proper certifications to satisfy such requirements.

[02:25:55] The American Sign Language Teacher Association has changed the names and structures of their certifications, as has the Registry of Interpreters of the Deaf. In addition, the Registry of Interpretations the death have also incorporated the national association for the death certificates because the national association for the death no longer issues the certificates amendments to the regulations are required to update the certificate in accordance with the national organization changes in their issuing of certificates specifically these updates are highlighted

[02:26:29] in your agenda item today and align with the national organizational requirements you'll notice the proposed amendment strikes the language of the older certificates and reflects the historical changes in the organization and certificates while keeping in the same standard of certifications required for the as endorsement again the amendments will follow the fast-track rule-making requirements of administrative processes act and you'll note that on january 31st of 22 abtel reviewed the proposed modifications and recommended that the board of education

[02:27:08] approve amendments to the licensure regulations for school personnel to compart with the american sign language national certificate and in conclusion the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board of education receive for first review the recommendations of the advisory board to amend the licensure regulations for school personnel to reflect CHANGES WITH THE AMERICAN SIGN LANGUAGE NATIONAL CERTIFICATE.

[02:27:33] I'M AVAILABLE FOR ANY QUESTIONS. ANY QUESTIONS? THANK YOU, SIR. DR. JOHNSON, FORGIVE ME FOR MISSING IT IN THE LITERATURE, BUT COULD YOU PLEASE HELP ME TO UNDERSTAND THE DIFFERENT LEVELS OF AN INTERPRETER AND HOW THAT APPLIES TO THIS FACT TRACK?

[02:27:56] SURE. AND AGAIN, I'M NOT AN EXPERT, BUT IF YOU TAKE A LOOK ON THE CHANGES THAT WE'RE MAKING TO THE regulations um they have changed let me find what item it is so on under um i guess it's small a under 2a1 notice they have they are removing the valid provisional qualified and professional certificates and issuing just one american sign language teacher association credential

[02:28:31] and you'll know removing the moving the three three levels just making it one that's correct thank you ma'am sure anybody else dr man the the primary purpose to make sure our regs align with what these entities are doing that essentially issues certification in american sign language because we're not in compliance at this time thanks okay that's it then the board will happily

[02:29:09] accept this on first review item n first review of alternative accreditation plans good morning good morning in this meeting till the rain stops so good morning president gecker vice president mann and superintendent baylow

[02:29:43] my name is amy sitka and i am the director of accountability i am presenting you information on the alternative accreditation plans that were submitted for your review by eight schools representing four divisions in january 2020 the final review of alternative accreditation plans submitted at that time the board requested that videoe ensure that future alternative accreditation plans aligned with the new 2017 accreditation model at the board's request working committee of virginia department of education staff members outline new guidelines

[02:30:23] for schools at the november 21 board work session shelly lyder and i discussed a realignment of the alternative accreditation plans and sought the board's guidance to ensure that the realignment

efforts met your expectations the plans submitted today reflect the realignment at that meeting as a reminder the legislative authority that grant school permission to seek approval of an alternative accreditation plan is in the standards of accreditation which states in part that special purpose schools may seek approval of an alternative accreditation

[02:31:01] plan from the board and that such schools would be evaluated on standards appropriate to the programs offered in that school the soa guidance document provides the language that the request for consideration for an alternative accreditation plan must be accompanied by information that documents the need for approval request the plans presented for your review today have supporting information and data that each school leadership team has determined substantiates their need for

[02:31:33] an alternative accreditation plan again a discussion of the process or the new guidance surrounding the alternative accreditation plans i would like to provide a quick refresher on our current accreditation model so that when i present the new guidance you can look at the and you look at the alternative accreditation plans they can be placed into context so there are nine indicators in our current accreditation model the college career and civic readiness indicator

[02:32:06] won't be active until the 23-24 accreditation year each of those indicators is assigned a performance level either a level one a level two or a level three and the combination of those performance levels determine a school's accreditation ratings if all of the indicators are a level 1 or a level 2 a school is accredited if at least one of the indicators is a level 3 the school is accredited with condition if a school fails to adopt or fully implement corrective action plans to address level

[02:32:44] 3 indicators they would become accreditation denied another thing that I just want to quickly explain is how the mark with a current year or a cumulative three-year rate the best of one of those rates or the school's performance rate is in the level range and the school shows sufficient improvement from the previous year to get a level to the school is near the state benchmark by having current or cumulative three-year rate and a specified range that's close

[02:33:20] to the benchmark or the school's performance rate is in the level three range and shows sufficient improvement from the previous year and a level three is if the school is well below the state's standard and does not meet the criteria of a level one or a level two with that background information i will move forward into the alternative accreditation process and the new guidelines there are four divisions who presented plans for you today are arlington county chesterfield county

[02:33:54] fairfax county and loudon county all of the schools listed except for kilmer center and key center are alternative education schools that service students who are having or have had difficulties in the past completing high school graduation requirements these students often have interrupted education maybe English learners who have entered school for the first time and generally our students who have had difficult life circumstances that negatively impacted their progress towards graduation Kilmer Center and Keith Center serve special education students some of whom

[02:34:31] are mentally fragile regarding the process for submission approval and implementation of the alternative accreditation and the first part of the process involves all of the steps taken to communicate with local school divisions regarding the opportunity to apply for alternative accreditation providing information to schools on what's allowable under the new guidance reviewing school plans providing feedback and the school's eventual submission of the plan to vdoe for presentation to the board the second part of

[02:35:08] the process is the review of the plans by the board and the last part of the process for those that have been approved is applying the alternative accreditation plans to the school data to determine a school's accreditation status it should be noted that the alternative accreditation plans are not an all or nothing document alternative measures are only used when the school does not meet a level one or a level two performance uh for an indicator and specific details surrounding all

[02:35:40] of the steps taken from beginning to end are in an attachment to the board uh agenda item document the next few slides outline the uh central established guidelines that were adopted based on uh committee discussions i will just very briefly review them to re re-familiarize you with the information the alternative accreditation plans must use established benchmarks for the performance levels at this as the state model so for instance the level one benchmark for english

[02:36:18] is a performance rate greater than or equal to 75 percent so that must be the same benchmark in the alternative accreditation plans as it is in the state i previously mentioned sufficient improvement when i was describing the performance levels under the state model demonstrating sufficient improvement can be used in conjunction with certain rate requirements to earn a level one or a level two rating schools using an alternative calculation can amend the rates that are used to to show improvement.

[02:36:55] For instance, changing an improvement rate from 10% that is used under the state model to perhaps 5%. But sufficient improvement cannot be removed from the performance level determinations altogether.

[02:37:12] The next criteria pertains to what is referred to as the floor for the achievement indicators. Under state accreditation calculations, a school must earn at least a 50% pass rate along with showing sufficient improvement to earn a level two rating.

[02:37:30] In the alternative accreditation models, school must also maintain a floor, but that floor can be amended, say perhaps to 45% if they have data that supports using a lower percentage.

[02:37:46] In addition, under our state accreditation model, the best of a current or cumulative three-year rate is used to determine a performance level. The guidelines for alternative accreditation plans state that schools can use more than three years to calculate a multi-year rate.

[02:38:03] For example, they may use four years, but schools cannot discount any data by using a best of scenario. So for example, a school cannot use the best of the last four years to calculate a three-year rate.

[02:38:19] In these alternative accreditation plans, all previous consecutive year data must be used in the multi-year rate without any exclusions. The guidelines on this slide indicate that schools using an alternative measure for achievement must still use the state assessments, though flexibility has been allowed to allow schools to use scores in the locally awarded verified credit range in the performance rate.

[02:38:48] The second bullet on the slide indicates schools are to track chronic absenteeism as per their divisions policy and state guidelines schools in their alternative accreditation plans are allowed to count days that students were physically not in the building but were engaged in learning as long as it is part of their division policy this parallels guidance that's in place now at the state level for schools as they address students who are uh in quarantine and receiving instruction another guideline is that the ccc calculations

[02:39:28] the college career and civic readiness indicator calculations with the state accreditation model but again there are some flexibilities allowed under this indicator many of the students in the alternative

schools carry 28 plus work hours a week to either support themselves or family members so schools were allowed to weave these experiences into instruction and count them within the indicator and last under the new model the new alternative accreditation models included to the

[02:40:04] greatest extent possible in all performance rates but again because of the nature of the school and the population that's in attendance there is flexibility to allow the exclusion of some students from the dropout graduation or chronic absenteeism rate most of these allowances are granted for students who enter the school for the first time after compulsory attendance age and are therefore not required to come to school but but do there's also flexibility allowed for students who have been incarcerated in addition when you review the plans you may see that school included

[02:40:44] another measure in their plan that was not part of the state accreditation model this is allowable under the soa other indicators would be used if a school would like to showcase based on school specific programs or effort and i believe two of the plans that you will be reviewing have utilized this option and lastly when you review the plans you will see descriptions of the school and characteristics to the school's population you'll see the rationales and historical

[02:41:20] data that supports the need for an alternative accreditation plan and a clearly explained methodology along with a sample calculation superintendent baylow is in support of the board receiving these plans for a first review at the next board meeting in april these plans will will be presented for a final review.

[02:41:43] We can have school representatives available at the next meeting to answer any specific questions you may have about their plans. And are there any questions that either Shelly or I can answer at this time?

[02:41:58] - Any questions by board members? Ms. Holton. - Not a question, but a comment. We'll first welcome back. I don't know if, I think this was your first time appearing before us back at the department. you to go back to the reviewed the accreditation standards back towards the beginning and i just want to suggest a proposed correction um i'm sure this is simply an oversight i'm sorry the level three red my incorrect understanding of our new accreditation model as i understand it so either i'm wrong or the slides wrong we were very clear that you don't

[02:42:39] level three indicates significant deficiency that needs to be addressed and has various consequences but it's not an accreditation denied consequence it we are very clear in the current accreditation standards that a school is not accreditation ad unless it either fails to adopt a corrective action plan or having adopted a corrective action plan fails to follow it and then the board of of Education specifically votes on a recommendation from the department.

[02:43:08] And I think that's a really crucial change in the accreditation standards that Nancy pointed out. The intent on this wasn't to look at that going across. A school is accredited with conditions when they just have one or more Level 3 ratings.

[02:43:27] And again, accreditation is denied is exactly what you just stated. So yes, the level three indicator, once they have more than one, one or more, they are accredited commissions. - I must have misunderstood. I thought I heard your interpretation translating level three accreditation.

[02:43:43] Thank you for that clarification. - Thank you, Mr. President. I would just thank you, and it's wonderful to see you in person. And just to underscore, the COVID-19 is a one year only, and if there needs

to be an additional addendum longer term it will be after one year is that correct yes okay i i really appreciate the thoughtfulness um put into that um i think it's really important that we don't base policy on what's happening today or what was happening three years ago but we leave enough of a a door open to

[02:44:23] define what that needs to look like in the future and so thank you for just carefully thinking about that and inserting that and i really just underscored that okay thank you the president yes sir dr durham just for final review if we can please remove the decision from arlington county so that i can recuse myself and vote separately on the others okay for two okay any other questions no i just really mr president i really appreciate this process and the work that

[02:44:56] into really trying to focus on how we address these issues from an accreditation perspective and just seeing the very detailed data that comes with these plans that really help give insight to the board around how these districts have really carefully considered what's coming before us i mean it really it reflects well on the great work that happened under our board members charge as we looked at accreditation so it's just great to see this come forward in this way so

[02:45:30] thank you for that thank you thank you very much for really very complete comprehensive presentation is there anything here that we could use to respond for example to dr siebert's comments this morning regarding the definition of chronic absenteeism and his concerns that we have a lot of just in the overall population is would the concepts embodied here for example the meaningful engagement concept be an appropriate way if if the board wanted them this is an answer i'm just

[02:46:08] trying to understand what's going on here uh if we decided to expand accreditation with meaningful engagement as an example be something that we could look at in the overall system for a period of time while we're going through the covet stuff well you don't need to have an eye you know well no i i can so um there has been guidance that was given out through the superintendent's memo that basically stated that if students were out on uh quarantine uh or were out because of illness

[02:46:43] that um if the schools were providing um learning for the students on those days that they could be counted as present so that guidance has been given i don't know how much that guidance has been implemented with fidelity in the field for just a variety of reasons i think at this point it might be a little bit difficult to go back um and kind of look at records if if schools weren't tracking the way they should have been but that is certainly um something that we can discuss

[02:47:20] thank you i i appreciate by the way that you cited and link to that superintendent's memo that allowed that guidance or that provided that guidance to the field and you know perhaps you know in discussions with dr siebert there may be some reference back to this and asking really didn't this cover it or do we really need to do more or is he looking for the 22 23 year instead of the 21 22 year that this particular memo covers so anyway uh with all that having been said i think that's it for comments

[02:47:56] thank you so much we will accept that happily on the first review uh i don't know ask me again yes you're not quite up to dr johnson level of reputation but maybe next meeting will keep you longer all right the uh this second presentation is on the covet 19 addendum to virginia's consolidated state plan as you are aware each state is required to have a consolidated state plan that provides all scholars with quality transparent information about how the every

[02:48:33] student exceeds act is implemented in their state as a result of the interruptions caused by the recent pandemic usc provided a streamlined process for uh state educational agencies to propose

modifications their consolidated state plans as they implement accountability requirements in 22-23 which is based on the school year's data uscd provided a covid19 template

[02:49:06] that allows seas to select the flexibilities from a list that are appropriate for the state based on the interruptions to virginia's federal accountability model over the past several years the modifications proposed in the addendum are to be temporary for one year and this addendum was posted for public comment from february 11th through march 11th there was a committee of practitioners meeting and the committee of practitioners is a committee that's mandated

[02:49:41] by federal statute and whose responsibility it is to advise the state in carrying out its responsibilities under type one that committee met to discuss the proposed covet 19 addendum on february 23rd and by and large the public comments and the committee of practitioners were support modifications in the addendum but there were changes to the original proposal as a result of the committee of practitioners recommendations and as a reminder the federal accountability model uses different indicators than the state

[02:50:21] accreditation model the federal accountability indicators are academic math and science participation in math and science growth reading and math chronic absenteeism English learner progress index for some of these indicators there's a measure of interim progress a lot of times they're referred to as targets and there are targets for each year currently through accountability year 24 25 and these targets bring schools towards a long

[02:50:58] goal the indicators which have targets not all of them do but the ones that do have targets are academic achievement and reading and math participation in reading and math though this target is the same every year it's 95 it doesn't change chronic absenteeism the federal graduation index and english learner progress so each of those have measures of interim progress on the slide is a screenshot that was taken from the videoe website

[02:51:32] where the state measures of interim progress are posted so the first proposal in the addendum is to move the current state measures of interim progress forward by two years for the indicators that have them. So this would take the targets that were in place in the 2020-2021 accountability year when accountability was first waived and shift them forward to accountability year

[02:52:04] 22 23 which is based on this year's data all the other targets would shift forward as well placing that last target year out to accountability year 26 27 and as you are aware many students learning has been impacted by school closures illness quarantine and virtual schooling so a shift in these targets was supported by public comment and by the committee of practitioners before i

[02:52:40] go into the remaining proposals in the addendum it's important to define the support status of some schools in wealth because the remaining proposals pertain to identification and exit of schools in and out of support so i first wanted to find what a comprehensive support and improvement school is it's a csi school is it's how it's referenced and a csi school

[02:53:13] are the lowest performing five percent of title one schools they're identified using a specific set of criteria and the data that's used is the data reported for the all students group csi schools also include any title one or non-title one high school in a state with a federal graduation index less than 67 percent in addition any title one schools that were previously

[02:53:49] identify as an additional targeted and support and improvement school that school didn't meet the statewide exit criteria within three years those schools are moved into csi status we do identify csi schools every three years and we currently have 39 schools that are in csi status a targeted support and improvement school is any title one or non-title one school with one or more

[02:54:24] student groups that meet the state's definition of consistently underperforming tsi schools are identified every year and we currently have nine schools in tsi status and then our additional Targeted support and improvement schools are a subset of the TSI schools.

[02:54:47] And these schools can be Title I or non-Title I schools with one or more student groups that are performing at a level that is comparable to schools in CSI stats.

[02:55:02] These schools are identified every three years and we currently have 38 schools identified for ATSI. all right we are going to review the remainder of the modifications these modifications again apply to we identify schools for support or how we exit schools from support status and just for information we'll be identifying and exiting schools from support in fall 2022 based on this year's data so schools

[02:55:42] will be answered based on this data the second proposed modification to the addendum is to change the methodology of how we identify schools in fall 22 for csi and tsi the funnels on this slide show the steps used to identify schools for csi or tsi the csi funnels on the left and the tsi funnel is on the right the schools that meet the criteria at each step and do not get

[02:56:20] removed from that those funnels are the schools that are identified for support it is really not necessary right now to really go through all the nuances identification process but I do want to focus on that third step of the process that uses chronic absenteeism and accreditation as a litmus to remove schools from that funnel so in our consolidated state plan for schools that have made it through step two and are still in the

[02:56:55] funnel the outcome of the third step is is this if a school meets the chronic absenteeism measure of interim progress and or is accredited the school from the funnel so it meets the chronic absenteeism measure of inner interim progress and or is accredited is removed from the funnel if a school does not meet the measure of interim progress for chronic absenteeism and is also not

[02:57:27] accredited then the school remains in the funnel there is a likelihood this year that there are going to be more schools that don't meet the chronic absenteeism measure of interim progress than in the past so therefore there may not be many schools that would be removed from the funnel at step three so since the purpose of the federal uh school improvement identification process

[02:58:01] is to provide support to to the schools that need it the most a different methodology uh is needed for this 22-23 accountability year so the proposed change to step three of the csi funnel is on the slide the consolidated state plan currently states of those schools identified in step one through two identify schools that did not meet the interim measure of progress for chronic absenteeism and have an soa rating of accredited with conditions or accreditation denied identify

[02:58:40] a number equal to five percent of title one schools for comprehensive support and improvement the modified language states that of the schools identified in step one and two we would first identify schools that do not meet the requirements for being accredited using the most recent school year data and then we would rank order these schools from least by chronic absenteeism and then identify the number of schools that's equal to five percent of the title one schools

[02:59:15] so this method does two things it captures the schools with the greatest absenteeism rates and the clarification surrounding accreditation the language is different is it ensures that the most recent school year data is what is used to determine the accreditation status of a school the change in language for step three of the tsi funnel is a bit more complex because there are

[02:59:53] criteria that must be met over two consecutive years however the change is based on similar reasoning reasoning chronic absenteeism will part of the process and the accreditation status will be based on the most recent school year data one additional caveat that was put in this step is to limit the number of schools that can be identified for psi to be no more than 10 of the public schools in virginia this is in there to keep the number of identified schools

[03:00:30] in a range in which the dov has the resources to serve and support them the third proposed modification in the addendum involves csi and atsi schools the proposal is to omit the two waived accountability years from the count of years that a school is in csi or atsi status the reason for this modification is because the current consolidated state plan if after three years

[03:01:05] a school remains in csi or atsi status for csi schools they would have to go through more rigorous interventions which involves a memorandum of understanding and for atsi schools if they didn't exit after those three years the school would be required to enter into csi status so since schools could not exit during those waived accountability years it seems reasonable not to count those years against a school when determining the time spent in a particular status

[03:01:48] the result of this proposed modification is that all csi schools and some atsi schools that were on year two of identification prior to the pandemic will be on year three and 22-23 if they do not enter if they don't exit in fall of 22 based on this year's data and if these schools were they would at that point move to the next step in the support process the next proposed modification

[03:02:27] which is modification number four is directly tied to proposal number three as previously stated schools who are in csi atsi status after three years are moved towards additional interventions or placed again in csi for those atsi schools in proposal number three we removed the waived accountability years from the count of years a school is considered to be in a particular status and in proposal number four we're adding an additional year to the number of years that

[03:03:04] schools can be in csi or atsi status before being identified for that next step this part of the proposal was not originally included in the addendum but the committee of practitioners felt strongly that placing schools into additional interventions in fall of 23 for not exiting csi or atsi was placing those schools in a very difficult position since the past several years have been challenging for many schools and more so for the schools that are already the lowest

[03:03:41] performing the committee requested a revision to the exit criteria timeline revision would provide an additional year for schools to meet the exit criteria allowing a fourth year before moving to the next step in the process is is what they requested and that actually is already allowable under s regulations though in the past virginia has not we've not opted to use it so again this

[03:04:11] would be only for this one time and for a very specific cohort of schools the result of this proposed my support and then this is the last proposed modification and that is to modify the exit criteria itself for CSI schools and current consolidated state plan states that schools can exit when they show improvement in reading

[03:04:50] and math performance from the time they were first identified and when they're no longer in the bottom five percent of the lowest performing schools the change for again fall 22 only and the proposal is that all currently identified csi schools can exit if they are no longer in the bottom five percent of the lowest performing schools based on 21 22 data and post covid data to look for that improvement is not likely a valid comparison as those two data sets

[03:05:29] uh were are being collected under very different circumstances especially for and as i stated earlier we are required to identify a new list of csi schools this fall and this identification will give us a complete list of the lowest performing five percent of all schools so this last slide just shows that we would not be changing our exit process except for this one time and fall 22 that is indicated by the red

[03:06:04] sentence that is that would be added to our current criteria and that come the proposed modifications we are asking the board to waive first review and approve uh approve the proposed addendum so that we can begin the approval process with uscd superintendent baylow has supported this request i have shelley loving rider and dr lee ortiz and dr lisa martin are also um in the audience from the office of school quality and if you have any

[03:06:40] questions we can answer them at this time members of the board any questions no miss holton uh so So maybe I missed this, but I'm uncomfortable on this one waiting for you because such important changes and that I want us to make sure we have thorough input from our stakeholders, in particular, the Superintendent's Association and the School Board Association.

[03:07:12] We heard from Mr. Seber today on the absenteeism issues. I'd like to hear, give them an opportunity to weigh in on these specific proposals. But what I may have missed is how much, did you say how much you've consulted with either Mr. Seaton in the group that he's talking about on absenteeism and/or VAS or the SBA?

[03:07:38] - The Committee of Practitioners is just a variety of people from a lot of different organizations and they did review the plan and we talked thoroughly through it for a while. - And I appreciate that effort and I appreciate that you are trying to figure out how to balance conflicting interests in this very, very difficult time and specifically trying to address how chronic absenteeism should be treated differently for this one year. But I'm not comfortable waving first review. I don't know what my colleagues will think, but based on the fact that this is

[03:08:15] so important, we want to make sure those stakeholders have an opportunity to help us make sure we get it right so is there some you know deadline we're gonna miss or something if we wait for sure you if we don't wait yeah we are trying to get this to uscd so that they can approve it before we can really do any of our reporting and out-to-school divisions which starts in July well luckily we do meet again yes we don't meet every month but luckily we do meet again in

[03:08:48] April. That would be my inclination, Mr. President, that we wait for further input. They may not have any, and this may be all perfect, but there may be some tinkering. It's very complex, and I can't claim to understand the news announced the way the locals will.

[03:09:07] If I may, Mr. Yekker, we did send this out to the superintendent's memo as well. The school divisions you know have been aware of the uh in addition to the 30-day public comment that we posted um just to be clear i think uh dr siebert's concern is about chronic absenteeism as it relates to accreditation as

opposed to our federal identification and so i think uh we perhaps will come before you again in april with some discussions around chronic absenteeism as it

[03:09:42] relates to accreditation as amy indicated our ability for flexibility under this particular addendum is somewhat restricted based on you know what the uscd allows us for flexibility and i will also say that with the public comment that was received there was no comments on the absenteeism itself there was two comments that related to the targets that they wanted us to

[03:10:16] completely redo the targets instead of shifting them but that that isn't part of uh the options that were given to us under this uh covet 19 addendum so um do you remember when the superintendent's memo went out actually i'm checking it's dated february 11th i'm just seeing you decided in your summary so in two divisions to pretend specifically referencing opportunity to comment on this matter so and you heard come back heard no comment back i will also

[03:10:56] say uscd um i'm trying to remember the the date that they were um requesting that this get turned in early march so like the third or the fourth yeah mr president i did have a question you reference one comment or one of the recommendations that did get changed as a result of the input.

[03:11:19] I just wondered if there were other recommendations, if you could just give some insight to some other areas that may have surfaced where changes were requested. - There were not other areas where there was any concern with what we were doing.

[03:11:34] They were actually very supportive of all the changes. Just their concern surrounding the exit timeline they just felt like school divisions needed grace to catch these students up um so that is where they were requesting that additional year to be in um those support status before we move them on to you know further action um but they they felt very strongly about that but they were just very supportive um they didn't have any other recommendations such as that one i received

[03:12:11] from public comment that we couldn't do but they they were just in full support of what we were doing and one one more thing president gecker um there is also a an opportunity for an amendment to our plan which is always available to states so you know should there be additional changes that we need to make it can be done through that formal amendment process as opposed to the identity that is being offered to states now i think we're actually at a point where we can uh recommend seek a motion to wave first review and proceed forward i think that's right isn't

[03:12:50] it miss halton yeah i i thank you for your clarification and for the fact that you sent this out to the soups over a month ago and heard no negative comment back and my closest soup tells me he thinks the soups are okay with it so i withdraw my concern thank you there you go okay Okay, so unless there are any other questions, is there a motion to wave first, review, and adopt item O?

[03:13:15] Thank you. Is there a second? Second. Thank you, Dr. Duran. Local soup. All in favor? Signify by saying aye. Aye. Any opposed? Aye. Thank you. That's it. Thank you very much. Awesome.

[03:13:32] Thank you. Okay.

[03:13:47] Dr. Say? Dossier of notes here. Okay. If you can recap the assembly session, you're doing better than most of the local press. we look forward to this well I must admit I was a little optimistic when I named this presentation and I don't know if we can truly call it a recap as some of the work is still underway so this is actually a bit more of a status update for you all given that several of the bills are going

into conference and will be carried into special session the largest which or I guess the biggest discussion item being our budget both the caboose budget and the new biennium

[03:14:25] budget for the 22-24 fiscal years. Let's get started here. Before jumping in, I just wanted to provide kind of a quick snapshot of what General Assembly session looked like broadly, not just for our folks here in education. We saw 3,143 bills and resolutions introduced during the 22 session, 1,767 of them being passed at the time of adjournment. That does leave 47 still

[03:14:59] pending, so those were those bills in conference. Here at the agency, we, of course, track closely all of those bills related to pre-K-12 education, and we have identified 250 bills that we were keeping an eye on. I will say a majority of these were directly related to pre-K-12 education, but, of course, that number does capture those things that are indirectly related or may have an indirect impact or even tangentially related. We want to make sure that we're keeping our finger on the pulse of anything that could impact us in the education space of of those 250 bills we have

[03:15:35] 68 pass as of march 12th um three pin which we will discuss more today um and that puts us at about a 27 pass rate um as we all expected education was top of mind for our legislators this year um but we didn't always reach agreement on on how to move forward with some of those topics how many of those 67 will are really aimed improving newton outcome oh gosh um i let me do the math for you and and get back um and and we might intuitively get to that number in the presentation as well um the themes and hot topics this year i think are probably what we largely

[03:16:14] all expected um in the nature of the discussion during the election you know what's happening with general assembly and committee work on the off season um and then of course some of the conversations that we see reappear year over year from our general assembly members. So I captured just a few up there. And again, I think probably none of them are particularly for anyone here. This was our first legislative session with Governor Yunkin in office. So after his inauguration,

[03:16:46] he did release a, so it's not dry. He did release a day one legislative agenda, which included a number of initiatives related to education. So I did want to highlight those here for you. um not all of his bills fared as well as others um so these really touch on the ones that are either have passed the legislature or moving towards passing um assuming that those bills are in conference so i will we'll touch on again just those that we will see work underway happening in the coming months and years the first two bills or i guess sets of bills rather um fall

[03:17:25] under this heading of innovative schools um hopefully i'm not being too presumptuous or or mischaracterizing the agenda, but I think this was at the top of the list for Governor Yunkin and making sure that works access to our innovative schools in the Commonwealth. The first sets of bills, House Bill 346 from Delegate Davis and Senate Bill 598 from Senator Pillian is expanding on something that we already have access to in the Commonwealth, which is our college laboratory preparation, excuse me, partnership laboratory schools.

[03:17:55] There we go, that's a mouthful. This really expands on the enabling legislation, and if you all are familiar with college partnership laboratory schools, as they are set out now in the code, they allow the Board of Education, so you all, to enter into partnerships with our institutions of higher education that have education preparation programs to create a school that can provide some innovative options for students in the region, and of course, create a pipeline and a space for teachers and their education preparation programs to get real hands-on experience and do things in the classroom.

[03:18:31] As I noted, this would be an expansion of that model and allowing any institution of higher education to enter into that partnership. And I guess I should say it's submitting an application to you all to be considered for entering into that partnership. And I think important and of note for this board is that they'll maintain that board review and partnership as an important and critical part of this college partner laboratory school model.

[03:18:57] Some of the things that these bills highlight, they do want the board or ask the board to give preferential treatment to college partnership laboratory schools that are proposing to serve our underserved communities and students, as well as those partnerships that would be with our historically black colleges and universities.

[03:19:17] This is among the bills that is currently in conference. So this one does have a bit of an asterisk on it. It is a conference because there are still some differences between the House and Senate versions of the bill, primarily in terms of the scope in which the application process is fleshed out and the ways in which would be engaged both in the development of the laboratory school process as well as the fiscal components of that.

[03:19:42] So those are some of the pieces that they are still working out over at the legislature. The next item is House Bill 127, also from Davis, which is around our academic year governor schools and ensuring the admissions process is open to everyone and non-discriminatory in practice.

[03:20:00] The language evolved quite a bit over the course of the General Assembly session and where they ultimately landed was really in line with the recent federal ruling around discriminatory practices and admission process. It does go a step further than just admissions to make sure that middle schools who are kind of considered pipelines for academic year governor schools are cooperating with one another.

[03:20:21] So students that would be eligible for applying to these governor schools have access to the same level of coursework, rigor, preparation. So they are queued up for success both in the admissions process and once enrolled at the academic year governor's school. The next bill I will note is House Bill 938 from Delegate Robinson, which is really kind of a work group and stakeholder bill to level set us in public education and to establish and be introspective about the goals of public education in the Commonwealth.

[03:20:55] This bill also went through a good degree of negotiation and a few different iterations, and where we landed in this final version of the bill, which did pass unanimously out of both chambers, was much broader than the original iteration.

[03:21:11] The introduced bill aligned largely with Executive Order 1, and this bill ultimately kind of took a step back broadly at the topics that were being addressed in Executive Order 1. One of the major points of negotiation and discussion of this particular bill was engagement with stakeholders.

[03:21:29] And so this final version and past version of the bill is very intentional to make sure that all public education stakeholders will be a part of the discussion and at the table as we reflect on these six topics here in the General Assembly and issued from the Secretary of Education and Superintendent by number one, 2021.

[03:21:53] Next is a bill related to parent engagement. Senate Bill 656, which is from Senator Donovan, will have the department taking a look in providing model policies related to the use of sexually explicit

content and identifying that content, making sure parents are notified that that content is available in schools or potentially used as part of the instructional material or curriculum, and then providing an avenue for parents to elect for their child to receive an alternative curriculum or instructional program for that particular module or or segment of instruction um this particular bill does does

[03:22:28] live with the department um i know the board has seems seen similar task in the past um but this will be model policies issued by by staff at the agency um taking into account of course the the board's existing regulations um in federal practice um and i you know i and i will also note um you know based on discussions from the board in the past that this bill does define sexually explicit content with a basis in the code. So it won't be establishing definition here, but really just giving school divisions some tools and resources on how to set up those policies for addressing

[03:23:00] this type of content. In-person learning, this is a bill I'm sure you all have read about in the news. So Senate Bill 739 advanced very quickly through the General Assembly session and through the legislator, actually even jumping over chambers prior to crossover, which addressed the need for in-person learning for at least the minimum 180 days and 990 hours as required in statutes.

[03:23:28] Of course that doesn't necessarily preclude divisions from offering virtual and remote learning options and in fact keeps intact legislation that passed in 2021 that allows for 10 remote learning days and again remote learning is still available above and beyond the 180 days and 990 hours but that minimum baseline expectation must be offered in person.

[03:23:50] as part of the evolution of this bill there was also a change to reflect the mask mandate and parental choice around mask in schools so once this was was sent up to the governor for signature and consideration he recommended an amendment that would allow and provide with parents choice for whether their student was masked while on school property so combination this addressed both in-person learning and of course health mitigation strategies while receiving in-person learning. This bill was signed on February 16th and because of its emergency enactment did go into

[03:24:24] effect March 1, 2022. So we are currently operating under Senate Bill 739. I will also mention there was a House companion to that bill, so House Bill 1272 from Delegate Batten, which just didn't have quite the same pace but is identical to Senate Bill 739. I will skip over this slide or move through it pretty quickly. I think we feel probably pretty adequately briefed on the literacy bill, But I'm happy to circle back to that if there's any additional questions about the components of the legislation as well as those corresponding bills And I and I guess I should quickly note for the literacy piece

[03:25:01] If you are looking at Governor Yunkin's day one legislative agenda And the literacy bill is actually not reflected on that list But because of the importance and the bipartisan support that bill garnered Did eventually become a governor's bill as part of the session another hot topic of discussion for us with school safety and discipline with a few bills passing in this in this regard at the first the first I guess companion set house bill four from delegate Wyatt and Senate bill 36 from Senator Normand response to some of the changes we saw from the 2020 legislature around when principals have the discretion to report certain misdemeanor offenses on school prop

[03:25:39] accessible way to read that component or code and gives a clear direction for when principals do have discretion to report certain misdemeanor offenses and and when it's required to report on certain criminal offenses regardless of whether that be misdemeanor or a felony offense.

[03:25:57] So there are a few carve outs there in terms of what type of, again, what type of offenses need to have notification for law enforcement. And one of the things of this bill is also maintaining and reinforcing the parental notification piece when a child or student is subject to a criminal offense that parents are made aware promptly and timely.

[03:26:19] House Bill 873 has our school resource officers serving on our threat assessment team. This did go through a number of iterations. Originally, it would have required school divisions to staff a school resource officer, which we know are based on the product of cooperative agreements between our local law enforcement agencies and our local school boards.

[03:26:40] There was concern about the capacity of some school divisions to bring that level of staffing on at this space. So this bill is a reflection of local school board's interest hiring SROs as well as their capacity to do so, but making sure that there is still that level of collaboration and cooperation between local law enforcement and the local school boards as they think about their safety environments. And I think very much in that same vein, House Bill 1129 from Delegate Taylor and Senate Bill 600 from Senator Pillian, also just really kind of reinforces that important collaboration between our local law enforcement agencies and our school divisions as we think about school safety.

[03:27:19] so making sure that chief law enforcement officers or their designees are active part of school safety audit processes additionally there was legislation that supports our military families specific to the provision of early child care services house bill 994 and senate bill 529 from delegate brewer and senator reeves respectively have the board of education taking a look at their regulations to make sure that we are providing access and ready access to our military families with regard to the child care subsidy program um this does look a little bit different than the

[03:27:55] introduced version of the bill as well which would have required um the board to take regulatory change or make a regulatory action but to make sure that we are in compliance with the federal requirements around the child care subsidy program and meeting the goals and the intent of the legislation this is a reflection and a chance for us to look at the feasibility of that and explore avenues for moving forward in the regulatory process those touch on all of the major items and pieces of legislation that align with Governor Youngkin's day one legislative agenda but I know that there was a lot of other activity over at the legislature that would be of interest to you all

[03:28:34] so I wanted to highlight a few additional bills as well. I will try to keep this brief and move through these pretty quickly so if I'm clicking too quickly through the slides we can always return but want to be cognizant of your time since we've moved from the morning to the afternoon now. two items i will quickly note regarding to regarding staffing um house bill 829 recognizes um the the difficulties that some of our local school divisions are seeing with regard to hiring um their school counselors which is currently set as a ratio of one to 325. um so this

[03:29:08] does give school divisions two pathways and flexibility for meeting school counselor ratio one of which is is setting um currently licensed practitioners either in the counseling space social workspace or clinical or psychologist space to to go on the path to becoming a school counselor and licensed via the board of education but recognizing that may not have that credential initially and out of the gate so they would be able to be hired as a provisional licensed individual and school counselor with the intent and the expectation that they are working towards full licensure in the school counselor space and and if they are meeting those credentials

[03:29:45] would be counted towards that one to 325. Alternative local school divisions are able to annually contract with these alternative licensed health and behavioral associates to meet that position if they weren't able to get applicants to meet those vacancies. Senate bill 490 also addresses staffing at our local school division level. This was original standards of quality bill which did successfully make it out of the senate's policy committee but over the course of the the legislature so we saw some movement on the needle or movement of the needle this did get scaled back to address our school leadership so this bill will

[03:30:23] require one elementary or one principal in each elementary school which currently is set at a ratio of students and one assistant principal for every 500 students at the middle and high school level if you all recall just a few months ago this was among the board's SOQ prescriptions which did recommend again an elementary school principal in every school and an assistant principal for one at once 400 students so um not and it's a full implementation of that particular prescription but a partial one this is one of the items that is moving forward in special session so still under

[03:31:00] discussion um the biggest part of that that discussion i believe is the the budget piece um there was a budget amendment reflecting the staffing requirement on the house side so more work to be done to make sure that both budgets or the reconciled budget reflects that staffing.

[03:31:20] Next are assessments, and I will be honest, this bill has evolved quite a bit, and even since I put this presentation together, so this isn't a perfect encapsulation of what this first House Bill 585 from Delegate Board seeks to accomplish.

[03:31:36] And what this does is this is really kind of at the intersection of the conversation around moving towards the federal minimum in terms of testing, but making sure where that gap continues to exist and how we're testing and assessing, making sure students are receiving content, that there's state capacity and local capacity to ensure we still have that knowledge, data, and information available to us.

[03:31:58] So this will align with language that we've actually already proposed as part of the standards of accreditation language that moves us to the federal minimum at our high school level for our end of course assessments. For those, for certain sets of tests, at the high school level and the middle school level it will eventually assuming that money is appropriated for it tasks the department with expanding those types of tasks to include items allow the student to apply knowledge and skills which can include open-ended and long-form writing among other tasks as part of the test so i know we talk about performance based assessments a lot

[03:32:35] in this forum as well as over at the general assembly it wanted to provide kind of a consistent understanding of what we mean when we talk about performance-based assessments as well as marry that with the understanding that we need to make sure that we're testing for all content so this i guess in some form hopefully not making up new vocabulary in the space is a blended model that reflects both a you know multiple choice and content-based assessment as well as a performance-based assessment so there's some real-time engagement there house bill 197 from delegate weber was originally meant to address the the through your growth assessments which

[03:33:10] were recently passed from the general assembly recognizing that some school divisions had already built in and purchased their own growth assessment models this evolved recognizing that it's it's meaningful and important for us to have a consistent look at our testing model to see how we might emulate and better learn from other and growth model growth vendors or growth models to improve our

testing system as we move forward with implementation of the growth models related to to our Board of Education.

[03:33:42] We have two bills that are tied directly to your work, and I would say all of it's tied directly to your work, but you might get very real effects of these two bills. So House Bill 879 requires the Board of Education to include someone with a member with experience in local governments or policymaking, one member with experience in career and technical education, and one member with experience in early childhood, which we do currently meet at the moment.

[03:34:10] and of course, recognizing the critical functions that the board plays. You all might recall in 2020, JLARC had issued a report on the operations of the Virginia Department of Education with two recommendations for membership of the Board of Education. One addressing kind of geographic, how we're divided geographically, as well as this membership component.

[03:34:31] The geographic piece had passed last session, and now the membership and credentials is as part of the makeup of the board moving forward. Delegate Davis has also proposed the re-entry of the Student Advisory Board.

[03:34:46] As I understand it, this is something that happened in years past. And this will have representatives from each of the eight divisions or superintendents regions or students being represented from each of the eight superintendents regions on this advisory board at which time they will be able to engage, discuss topics that's relevant to your discussions as well as other things that they deemed necessary and would have an opportunity to bring a presentation to you all.

[03:35:17] In the early childhood space, House Bill 389 from . I won't spend too much time on this as an agency bill, but it was really largely technical in nature and doing some last cleanup work with respect to that transition of early childhood oversight from the Department of Social Services and Department of Education.

[03:35:35] So making sure that we tied up all of our loosens there nice pretty bows and of course had the infrastructure in place to continue us moving forward with our shared vision for early childhood. Additionally, there was legislation around the access and administration of epinephrine and universally supported just explaining how we approach access and administration of epinephrine in the k-12 space to our early child care providers.

[03:36:03] In our special education, we obviously saw a lot of activity in that space in the last session as as a result of the JLERC study. So it's very important work happening with respect to our language acquisition and developmental milestones for a student who are deaf or hard of hearing.

[03:36:22] So this has the board and several other state agencies convening an advisory group to really establish and take a look and select what those language development milestones will look like for those students, parents with resources for identification, supporting those students and making sure that division and parents assessment tools for that identification process is also translating to a reporting requirement for the department so you're continually continuing to take a look at how students are performing with respect to their peers i will breeze through this side pretty quickly um i think probably the

[03:37:02] the theme and takeaway for our teacher education and licensure bill are really streamlining our pathways to licensure and renewal of licensure recognizing some extenuating circumstances for our

our military families who are often transitioning and moving from one state to another, the ongoing impacts of the COVID-19 pandemic and the opportunities that teachers have had to get professional development points and the credentials they need for license renewal, as well as the refugee crisis and all of the talented individuals that we have coming to the United States with strong educator credentials

[03:37:36] that don't have a clear pathway to licensure here. School construction was another big topic top of mind For our legislators, we obviously were briefed and stayed on top of the work happening with the School Construction and Modernization Committee.

[03:37:54] And these bills are a result of that 63 and Senegal 473. We're looking at, we'll set up for a new funding program is set aside and conference to work out what specifically the school construction program would look like, the varying kind of ideas for whether this would be based on LCI, whether it's the scale of loan or size of loan.

[03:38:19] and how grants might be administered in the process but there is a shared understanding that would be a grant program as opposed to a loan to local school divisions to really support them in their school construction work and as part of that larger universe these bills do also have the department of education working with the department of general services to develop so school divisions have the data and the means to take a look at their current inventory of school buildings better assess what they would need in terms of funding to maintain those buildings moving forward so giving them a tool for their budgeting process lastly i will touch on a few

[03:38:56] things related to the appropriation act and i won't take too much longer here um this year we did here um two bills or two versions of the bill one being house bill 29 the caboose budget so closing out those last few years of this fiscal year 22 and then buying a budget which would carry into the 24 fiscal year um i will say very little has changed in the the 29 the caboose budget um since the introduced version um with the exception of some potential compensation supplements as well as increases in per pupil um via the infrastructure and operations per pupil

[03:39:31] fund but it largely looks like the introduced um caboose um since that's still largely under discussion um i know it's a little bizarre to talk about creation act without money um or numbers but i wanted to make sure that you all at least had a sense of the policy themes and discussions that are happening house bill 30 which is our biennium budget you'll see quite a number of topics being addressed um as part of the end use budget um some of them the technical updates which we expect um from most most biennium budgets um to reflect the ongoing impacts of the pandemic

[03:40:06] as well as some of the expected changes we're going to see in the sales taxes um compensation supplements for our teachers um some new staffing requirements um ways to think about school construction and then staffing internally for our office of school quality as we move towards a more regional model in that space and i thought this last slide i was brilliantly summarizing where we are all those conversations but what i realized that i read it is that all of those conversations are still underway um so everything that we talked about in the introduced budget is still very much a part of the discussion for our legislators as we work towards a reconciled

[03:40:44] budget so there we have it um 22 session and i am happy to to dig in on any of those individual bills with you um not a question uh however it is a comment that i'll end with don't you agree but sale did an amazing job this session uh thank you it was reflected in in the presentation and the informed presentation and um just really really appreciate your work this was a busy busy

[03:41:16] I will end with don't you agree as well, but don't you agree that the one thing we should add to yesterday's discussion of the literacy act, that in addition to Delegate Coyner's amazing work patrooning it in the House and Senator Lucas' amazing work patrooning it in the Senate, that Delegate Gacker deserves credit as a chief co-patron, having really been the originator of the idea uh that resulted in this great latest life work this year i'm

[03:41:52] happy to have that reflected on the record here carried it all away okay i think that's it thank you dr stale you know there may actually be some discussion uh there may be some discussion on the written report uh would it be possible because i think there will be some discussion on the written report and we've been sitting here for a while and it would be good to be able to sit here a while longer not too much longer i promise but just a little while longer we're going to take

[03:42:29] five minutes and we'll be back at five uh thanks everybody for hanging with us uh dr ortiz i know

[03:48:18] that this was meant to be a written report but there have been if again i can get my errant children over here to stop chatting in the corner very excited uh it was meant to be written but we're uh you know there are some items that are i think of critical importance to the work of the board you know one of the theories of the mou is that you know we're the state we can help and uh you know i'd like as we go through this some commentary and i'm by the way i think the work

[03:48:53] you're doing is excellent so don't take and i sit in on mou calls so i have in a position to judge what we're doing and how we're doing so don't take that comment as a negative but it's important that the board as a whole understand what we're doing how we're doing it why we're doing it and And frankly, the MOUs themselves, we have seen disparities, but certainly different language and different MOUs.

[03:49:20] I remember the, for example, the MOU, the first one with Petersburg, I guess it wasn't really the first, but the first one with Dr. Newsom, which I guess was the 12th, one with Petersburg, very specific cooperation provisions in it with regard to the board, the relationship between the board and the superintendent.

[03:49:38] Can't help but read the local paper and see what's going on with the divided board here in the city. That is of concern because I think one of the things I've noted as we've been going through the MOU, the school improvement process, is that in order to get better, there needs to be some alignment between the board and the superintendent.

[03:50:01] And a real desire to make student improvement the goal as opposed to whatever battles are going on at the adult level outside. I mean, certainly hope you would agree that in Petersburg, we saw that change in attitude at the board and their leadership and their cooperation with the superintendent, the current superintendent has been excellent.

[03:50:25] And we've seen, you know, despite the COVID backslide that everybody's experienced some real progress in the administration of the Petersburg school system. As an example, I'm not gonna click on each of the schools, but if you don't mind just, and I know I'm catching you a little bit cold, but if you don't mind just sort of commenting on where you think we are with the school improvement process, how we can help, what changes, if any, we ought to make to the MOUs, what common themes we see in the MOU jurisdictions, you know, I'd be very appreciative of that.

[03:51:01] And I said that this goes to the core of the work board, which is improving outcomes in those places where we need it the most. - Well, thank you, President Gecker. And yes, I did try to just slide in the written report for you all, and so if I don't mind obviously answering any questions related to the work that we do.

[03:51:19] And so, again, thank you for having me and members of the board and Superintendent Bailo. And so really, honestly, it's a lot to unpack. I'll start with, we currently, that exists, that says that the MOU should be reviewed annually and modifications made based on the evidence progress, lack of progress, or identification of additional need.

[03:51:41] And so with a new state superintendent, light of COVID-19 continued instruction it is a good time to review and make some revisions to the MOUs and so I would like to say first and foremost that we'd like to bring that to a work session so if approved then we can look at an April or May work session for review of the MOUs but to answer your question as far as progress that we've seen the first MOU that we can go back to was 2004 we've had divisions that have come out of an mou back into an mou and so we really have

[03:52:18] worked over the last few years but year and a half um that i've been with the office of school quality to take a transformational approach and a divisions level approach and so what's happening at the central level that's impacting the principal that's impacting the teachers it's impacting the students um and then obviously now we're seeing more in line with the um governance and school board relations and how that now is impacting or playing a larger role um in what's happening um affecting student outcomes and so um president gecker i'll take any specific questions but i'll say is there a need for provisions of the mous and for us to take a look at them absolutely um

[03:52:55] are there still challenges and divisions that we're working with absolutely um hoping the last time that we left in october ms holton had said this is great data we need more and so try to make sure that you all could see the comprehensive support that we are offering it is sometimes a challenge to capture it outside of like quantitative data to really see the qualitative piece how we're pushing in with every chief in every one of our divisions within mou um and amy siptica when she came forward earlier she talked about the identification of those schools and she said well how many can we serve and support well there are 38 tsi there are 39 atsi so in addition the

[03:53:35] office of school quality works with 300 identified schools 300 identified schools plus the five divisions within mou and so we go into a lot more in building capacity we've um hired we've built out our team when i came on we had a team of 12 we're up to 18 now so with the support obviously we've been able to build out a little bit um obviously we want some continued support and growing uh we identified consultants that have helped us to do some of that um you know feet on the street you know they're there boots on the ground in divisions um so are you mentioned you

[03:54:09] know petersburg's mou is very um specific it has a school board governance piece because it was tied to um when the superintendent was there um and so with the mo right now they are very different um we have some that exit criteria looks different we'll have the review and approval of administrative personnel that looks different depending on the division um new or modified instructional programming looks different based on the so obviously we push in and we use what support we can from the corrective action plan or cap um but at the end of the day if we can

[03:54:48] to the mo use it will be helpful in our work as well there's two one provision i don't think you mentioned but i may have just missed it as i was looking at the report uh i think you know rich we have the ability to be have a non-voting board member in 24 25 maybe maybe 25 26 i don't remember if all schools aren't accredited you know that's not a provision that flows through all of them either i don't think is that right if i heard you correctly you're asking about the one that yes yeah it's not there yet but it's a provision in the current mou that essentially says that if

[03:55:28] schools aren't accredited by, I forget the dates, like I said, 2425 or 2526, I just don't remember, then we get to have a non-voting board member. I don't think that flows through all of our MOUs. You are correct, sir. That is only included in the Richmond MOU, and it's something that we can definitely talk about.

[03:55:50] Ms. Halton, I'm not even going to wait for you to say. Thank you, Mr. Decker. You know I care deeply about this. I really think this is at the heart of one of the most important things we do that the department does, that the board does, and so thank you for bringing this forward. Thank you for reminding me also that I asked for more data because I'm now going to change my tune. I read through the 133 pages on these five divisions, and I tell you what, I cannot find the forest for the trees. I really can't.

[03:56:24] And so I would love to have us have a work session, and I would love to have it emphasize forest for the trees and i hope that your work with the divisions that while you're working on lots and lots of um provisions of the mous that that you and the districts have each district has you know three to five no more than five key goals that they're working on what are those key goals and how are they progressing on them and what's within their control and what's not and so i'm just doing some back of the envelope calculations one of the things i remember when we last heard

[03:56:59] from the petersburg superintendent and i think it may have been back when we were in person i don't even remember how long ago it was but we heard major work they were doing on um staff and in particular had large you know having a hard time recruiting licensed teachers so they were had a program to recruit provisionals and trying to figure out how to train those provisionals up and get them licensed and keep them i'd love to see an update on that i'd love to see an update on staffing throughout and in my own as i say back of the envelope calculations trying to put some of

[03:57:35] the numbers in the reports into context which the reports really don't you know they tell us the number of vacancies as of february 2022 numbers that look quite high but i don't know how that compares to the number of teachers in the division so i can't put it in context but my back of the envelope calculation suggests some of these divisions have very high vacancy rates right now you know however many months we are into the school year they've got huge numbers does that mean empty classrooms does that mean long-term subs what does that mean and it's just heartbreaking to think and you know this goes back to when i was more intimately involved in

[03:58:15] petersburg when we figured out that you you know prize that kids aren't passing algebra there's no algebra teacher are we still in that same mode in some of these divisions or in all of these divisions and and i also would be interested and so i'm talking too long as usual but i would be interested in the through line you know what are we seeing across our trouble divisions and what can we learn as a um as a board and as a state from those things so if they are all having trouble filling positions is that something that's within their control or are those factors beyond their control

[03:58:51] that are consistent across our poverty, our challenge districts? Is there more we as a state can do? So either the department or the board. The staffing is one thing I know we have heard before. As I say, my perhaps totally wrong calculations suggest that it's a huge problem in a number of these divisions. Is it something they're not? And they're all saying what are we doing about well we're going to do more job fairs and recruit for we're going to put more advertising on our websites well if that's you know is that going to affect it or if you've

[03:59:29] got you know some of these again you know some of them have eight nine ten one maybe i calculated as over ten percent that must be totally wrong um vacancies ten percent vacancies as of five six six months in the school year.

[03:59:48] Please tell me that's wrong. I would love to have a work session on it and I would love to have big picture understandings of their biggest challenges and what we're doing about it and are they making progress? Are they doing what they need to be doing? And the challenges are just beyond their control.

[04:00:04] Oh, and also what are their strengths? What's getting better? It does look like, again, my rough calculations, some of them are doing really remarkably well on graduation rate under the circumstances. And so Ms. Hilton, I'll answer some of those questions. Way too many, way too many questions.

[04:00:20] And maybe the biggest is can we do, agreeing with you that let's come back and do this in more detail later. For sure. Just wanted to share the five areas that are broad areas for all five of our divisions within MOU and the areas that you talked about, like kind of subtopics under there, like patrician and what's happening, how are they recruiting, things like that.

[04:00:39] But our five key areas are academics and student success, leadership and governance, operations and support services, human resource leadership, community relations, and communications. However, once we go in, each one of those divisions, so they have a division level review, then obviously we're working with their team and we're getting some more insight as to what areas are further along, where can we, where are some, I don't wanna call them easy ones, 'cause all of them take work, but where are some quick wins that we can capture and celebrate, and then where are some areas that are a longer road for you to travel?

[04:01:09] And so when you mentioned one of the divisions that still has all of those vacancies, We're still working alongside that particular smaller division, one of our divisions here in region one. This was the first year that they had not had anyone resign in December. And so they have not seen the attrition.

[04:01:26] So we work closely with them and their HR, but that's their, you know, again, that personalized support, that's an area we really can get movement on that we're gonna focus in the HR area. We don't lose that academic structure, that's always our first go-to. There are some other areas, if operations, if something is happening with school board and school board governance, keeping you all from doing the work um that's focused on students and student achievement then we have a more of a hand in that particular piece so it truly is personalized um we meet with them with their essential actions and we say where are you on this long road are you in the initial stage are you in the full implementation stage and then we just kind of meet them where they are

[04:02:04] and again it just speaks to building capacity because when we step away they have to continue doing the work if the superintendent changes the system is still there the students are still there so how do we continue to meet the needs or or create a sustainable system provide resources that's so definitely on

board with coming back for the work sessions and and thank you for emphasizing the positive too so we as part of understanding the forest and the tree we want to understand when there are when there's progress when there's good news we absolutely want to celebrate it but i i do ask that you know let's let's be blunt and frank and so you know tell us when somebody is

[04:02:39] struggling on governance and somebody is succeeding on governance you know even though that requires you to get your uh subjective but your uh your professional assessment of what's moving in the right direction and what's not you know i'm gonna i for one i'm gonna hope to pin you down on that so that we can understand and and you know you will um some division and petersburg was one petersburg's board now is a they are actually going to vspa training to be a model school board a board to watch where five or six years ago that was not an area that we would want to watch and

[04:03:16] celebrate right and so you know more recently most recently in richmond we've had some conversations about governance manual what can we do we put back to policy a lot of time what did your policy say how can we help to support because we're supporting the memorandum understanding has the superintendent board so we hold the board accountable as well and president gecker mentioned the meetings that we attend for their bi-annual updates so yes and no there are areas that can speak specifically when you're ready to have those conversations so dr doran did you have anything this is a kind of fall in a wave and also goes back to what you opened up with you said that

[04:03:52] uniformity is one area of revision what are some areas high level that you could see that you would bring to us revisions potentially just high bucket because i know we're going to talk about it later but it coincides with what this holton's questions were because i think if there was a in my mind but i want to hear from you in my mind if there was a revision of the mou some of the questions that consultant is asking would be a little bit more easy for us to understand it as we read to them so just any thoughts on that and so um president gecker had mentioned the possibility of having a member of the agency on the local school board. So that would be a piece if we were considerate,

[04:04:31] if that was something that, you know, the board wanted and Superintendent Baylow wanted, then obviously we will put that forward as a revision. Right now, we know the turnover that's happening with superintendents. And while we want all of our superintendents to stay and begin and be supported, now, if there is a vacancy, they have five days to bring some divisions, not every MOU, bring those names forward to you all how far do you all want to reach in that process and not to you all it actually would go to um the president and then superintendent of instruction um and so again those are pieces that are not uniform in any mou even speaking to the exit criteria which

[04:05:09] i know is a little further down the road because obviously we don't talk about exit we want to provide as much support but you know we have some mous that are written where it's an exit as soon as soon as all schools are accredited where others have to sustain accreditation for two years. And so those are just some of the high-level pieces that we get to look at, but flexibility is really in the cap.

[04:05:27] That's where we dig down in that identification of additional need or, hey, you all are successful here. We're not gonna monitor that every other month. We're gonna go to every six months, something along those lines, so. - Anybody else? Dr. Ortiz, thank you so much.

[04:05:42] You know, let me just say, I know you broke it down into five categories and break it just myself into three. And I think it's important the board understand we don't have the ability to go, that is the students. We don't have the ability to hire, the ability to essentially take over operations of the division.

[04:06:03] The three I have, and I think they're really aligned with yours from what I've seen over the couple of years. Number one is the goal of the department is to build administrative capacity. And if you remember in Petersburg, one of the first things that Dr. Newsome did was build staff around him for administrative capacity.

[04:06:22] And fortunately, that administrative capacity survived the transition from Dr. Newsom to Dr. Petrie-Martin as an example. And if you disagree with this, go ahead. You are the professional. I'm just a layman trying to understand what I've seen over the last four years doing this.

[04:06:40] So if we can build administrative capacity and have it stick, that will filter down, the theory is, through the jurisdiction. will help build stronger building leadership and help therefore build stronger teachers to the extent and hopefully help the administration you know figure out how to hire sufficiently to meet your uh question about you know vacancies second is frankly and this is not everywhere but we have seen cases where the school board itself is an impediment to progress uh they don't react interact

[04:07:16] well with the administration uh they don't understand their roles well there's internal dissension and you know one of the things we insist on and i think all the mous is a board education piece through uh vss virginia school boards not right that is correct yes and then the third area is and it made me to see how often this comes up is just how to get the curriculum aligned with the standards i mean i i'm sort of shocked every time i see a division whose you know purchased curriculum does not align with the standards and then you wonder why we're not

[04:07:52] doing well against the Virginia standards. And so I think, and again, you are more correct than I am in terms of your five, but just from the layman's overview, those are the areas I think we've been able to focus on. That's used inappropriately that you and the department have been able to focus on to assist the jurisdictions to the extent we have. I mean, I remember Dr. Lane going down to, you know, we'll use Petersburg one more time, in a very positive of way, walking into elementary school classes in different schools, and how happy he was

[04:08:30] that the same things were being taught at the same time, that they had gotten education to the point where everybody understood what was supposed to be taught and how it was supposed to be taught, and there was uniformity within the division, which is something, frankly, that had not been there before, and, you know, it's small things like that that begin to to make a difference in terms of outcomes.

[04:08:51] But I think we ought to do a work session on school improvement. It is a large part of what we're about. Everything, even Secretary Gadara mentioned, we need to be focused on those who aren't doing as well. And that is what OSI is all about.

[04:09:11] So thank you again. I'm sorry to hijack your written report and make you stand up. But it is something as we move forward through the year and frankly for me through June of 23, it's something I think we need to start focusing on more.

[04:09:30] So thank you. Any other questions, comments? No. - I did want to leave. I'm standing between you all and lunch. But when you talk about that curriculum as a third big bucket, and it obviously is covered under the big five, and I don't want to get ahead of one of our divisions, but Danville, if you look at their report and their data, speaks to the work that they have dug in to as far as curriculum revisions.

[04:09:53] And that has been, you know, their new sheet, that's a new superintendent a year or so. And so they really spent a lot of time on their curriculum. We sent a team down there from the agency and if you

look at their data, it is substantially different than the other divisions.

[04:10:09] And that's why, in a positive way. - Thank you. - Okay, well, appreciate you. Thank you all for that. - All right, last but not least, Ms. Holton. - Thank you, Ms. Gecker.

[04:10:24] I didn't notify the president that I have one thing I wanted to raise in our discussion of current issues, and that is the history standards upcoming. I have two books that I want to gift to you as Superintendent Baylow, and ask that you perhaps share with our Cristania Brown and others in the history world as we're working on the upcoming history standards.

[04:10:48] revision. Both of these are a point of personal privilege, if you will forgive me. Bill Robertson was a senior advisor in my dad's administration when he was governor of Virginia from 1970 to '74. He was the first African American in a seniorship role in Virginia and as an African American Republican, served the Commonwealth well in advancing the causes of ending segregation and helping move Virginia into the 20th century, and he passed away in the fall, but just this

[04:11:28] month his memoir came out called "Lifting Every Voice," and it's really a quite -- he's a great storyteller, remarkable life and remarkable stories, and would be a great subject to to be included in some fashion in the standards and/or curriculum framework. It's a great read that would be perfect for middle school and/or high school students. And therefore, I hand that book to you. The other one, also point of personal privilege, a little bit fatter, but my brother, Woody Holton, is a history prof at the University of South Carolina, and he came out with his latest book this fall, "Liberty is Sweet:

[04:12:06] The Hidden History of the American Revolution, and it's a fascinating read and in particular highlights a lot of Virginia pieces, as any history of the revolution would, but also particularly the hidden history is a lot of the groups whose role in the revolution aren't always fully, stories aren't fully told, and I know you coming from Wyoming are, have been well engaged with Native American history in Wyoming.

[04:12:35] Our Virginia Native American tribes have been less well highlighted and yet moving in the right direction, including got federal recognition recently after many, many years of working on that and their interaction between the Native Americans and the Europeans is a major theme running as it relates to the American Revolution is the major theme in this book among others, role of various groups that are not always, the story's not always told, role of enslaved populations.

[04:13:10] So this is a fatter one, probably not gonna be assigned to too many high school students, but might well be terrific for curriculum developers and/or high school history teachers, middle school history teachers, it's a great read.

[04:13:26] So again, shameless promotion of terrific books. - Mr. President and Ms. Holton, if I may, thank you so much, this means a lot. And as an avid reader, I also want to share that my father, I was just in Wyoming packing this last weekend, my 86 year old father asked me when he can visit as I told him about my visit with my best friend and sister last weekend to Yorktown.

[04:13:56] And we had intentions of making it to Williamsburg and Jamestown, but we were so enthralled by Yorktown, we didn't make it there. He is so interested in coming out and visiting the museums, which takes some special accommodation with an 86-year-old.

[04:14:13] And I'm going to do so many visits. Otherwise, I will not see him, but I look forward to taking me to my house and devouring him in the meantime, and so appreciate it. And incidentally, a little plug

for my dad.

[04:14:30] He was a State Board of Education member for 12 years. - Wow. - So, thank you so much. Thank you. - Okay, anybody else have any comments? Items, please. - President Gecker? - Yes, ma'am.

[04:14:46] - If I could, I would like to acknowledge and congratulate all of the wonderful student athletes who participated in state competitions in the last couple of weeks. The athletic trainers, the coaches, the admin, and the parents who traveled to Richmond in support of their student athletes tonight couldn't be more proud of everyone for displaying the proper amount of enthusiasm as well as sportsmanship during our return to Richmond for those games so congratulations to all of the winners and especially to those who participated congratulations and it felt good to have something

[04:15:24] of a back to normal feel to the sports and athletics. Absolutely thank you Dr. Davis-Faught. Anybody else? If not, we will adjourn. See you all next month. Thank you.